Beyond Etheria

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/38915532.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

Categories:
F/F, F/M

Fandoms:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018), He-Man and the Masters of the Universe

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Bow & Glimmer (She-Ra), He-Man | Adam & Adora (She-Ra), He-Man | Adam & Skeletor, Catra & Scorpia (She-Ra), Entrapta/Hordak (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra)

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Additional Tags:
Drama, Spoilers, Twins, Series: He-Man and the Masters of the Universe (2002), Catra (She-Ra) Redemption, Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Lesbian Adora (She-Ra), Crossover, Fights, Revelations, Brother-Sister Relationships, Magic

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Beyond Etheria

by IceAngelSimon

Summary

After the Horde was defeated, Entrapta picked up a signal from another dimension.

Notes

in this story there will be several references to the Netflix series She-ra and the 80's He-man.

See the end of the work for more notes

Invitation to the Ball



The Horde had been defeated at last. A great party was being organized in Bright Moon in celebration of the victory and in honor of the princesses who fought for the Rebellion.

In the castle, Catra was sitting in a corner of the room, isolated. She had declared her feelings for Adora, but now what? She had Entrapta's forgiveness, and apparently, Glimmer and Bow no longer held the anger they used to, but as for the others there was still a lot to fix and she didn't even know where to start. She looked at Scorpia as she interacted with the others, the smile she wore, and she felt more and more guilty for the way she pushed her away.

"Some problem?" Adora appeared, giving her a little fright.

"None." She turned her face "I'm not used to being surrounded by princesses, that's all."

“We're all on the same side now." the blonde smiled, held her hand "no one knows you like I do, it's just a matter of time..."

“Get out of here, Adora. I even understand you, since we grew up together, but they have no reason to forgive me, much less to like me..."

"What about Scorpia?"

Catra raised her ears, widened her eyes, but then closed her face:

"She has to be really stupid to forgive me..."

"But she hugged you, didn't she?"

“Because she's like that, she even hugs that stupid robot they call Emily. She likes to cuddle and I”—he lowered his head—“I don't deserve it. Not after all..."

Adora was worried, but she couldn't sit idly by.

"Come with me." She pulled her

"To where? Why?"

“Talk to the princesses."

"Are you going crazy?" She pulled her arm towards her "I already told you no!"

"Entrapta forgave you, do you really think Scorpia won't?"

“You don't understand! I can't just apologize!"

"And why not? Don't come to be proud now!"

"That's not it!" She put her hands on her head "I can't because... Because she'll forgive me, I know she will..."

"And this is not good?"

"It's terrible! She was right, I'm not a good friend! I will never be!"

"Catra..."

"Leave me alone!"

She ran out, would enter the first room she found in that castle, threw herself on a bed and buried her face in the pillows. She knew she didn't fit in there, now that the Horde was gone, she didn't know what to do with her life anymore. She heard someone knocking on the door:

"Go away, Adora!"

It opened slowly, pushed by huge red claws:

“It's not Adora. I saw you run out of the salon, are you all right?"

Catra didn't want to look at her, she didn't have the courage:

"I do not understand you..."

“Oh, I know it's weird being here with the princesses,” chuckled Scorpia, “but they're kind of welcoming. That Perfuma, especially, she..."

"It's not that!" Catra cut her off, then sat up straight "Why did you come after me? What's your problem?"

"Uh... I don't know how to answer exactly..." she tapped her claws against each other, a little shyly "I care about you and I wanted to know if you're okay..."

"But why?" She raised her voice "I yelled at you! Said it was useless! You abandoned me because I deserved it! So what are you doing here? Why do you even care?"

Scorpia sketched a smile, approached slowly and sat next to her:

“I still consider you my friend, my wildcat. I know what you did wasn't nice..." She scratched her head "But I have more good memories than bad, like when they took over the Crimson Waste... and everything we've achieved since Entrapta started working with us..."

“Entrapta…” Catra lowered her head, clenched her fists.

“I admit I was hurt, yes, but I don't hold any grudges against you. I know you were under a lot of pressure, hard work..."

"Did you really forgive me that easily?"

"Yes." She smiled "I always knew there was light in you."

"Scorpia…" She felt her eyes watering "You have a very good heart…"

'Maybe not so much, since I got a little jealous of your friend Adora" she said getting up, spoke a little fast "But that doesn't

matter, after all, now you're fine, it doesn't matter which friend could help you more."

"Wait..." Catra had a confused look "Are you jealous of Adora?"

"I have, I mean, I had! But friendship jealousy, how you always called her so much and how she even knows your favorite number and I don't..."

"What?"

"Nothing, nothing!" Scorpia was agitated, her claws moving as she spoke. "We're friends, aren't we?"

Catra managed a smile, it was hard not to be happy in her presence. He got up from the bed, opened his arms:

"Yes, we are, if you still want to..."

Scorpia was smiling from ear to ear, gave the cat a hug, lifting her off the ground.

Catra felt a little better about herself, she really regretted the way she had treated her before, but she knew that with the other princesses it wouldn't be so simple.

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Meanwhile, Entrapta was in her laboratory in the company of Hordak and Wrong Hordak, telling them her discoveries and her ideas since he went to the Beast Island.

"I even piloted a First Ones I named Darla!" Wrong Hordak was there, saw it all! Tell him, Wrong Hordak!

The clone smiled and nodded. The real Hordak eyed him a little suspiciously, without the Horde Prime to control them, perhaps he could free his other clone brethren. The princess's excitement made him happy, as if he were still part of something bigger.

If they were kept isolated in her laboratory, she hadn't found a way to tell the others she was with Hordak without them wanting to start a war, and as difficult as it was, she would keep it a secret for a while.

She was typing on her computer using her long hair, that's when she picked up some kind of strange signal that soon disappeared.

"What was this?" She was typing faster

"Some problem?" asked Hordak.

"My system picked up some kind of signal, but the location was totally unknown, almost as if... I need to check this!"

She moved quickly around the place, looking at several screens at the same time, concentrating.

"Did something happen?" asked Hordak

"Remember when you tried to open a portal to send a signal? There's someone trying to do the same, only... On the other side!"

He widened his eyes, stared at the screens with her. She was right, a signal had been emitted from another dimension, if only for an instant.

"I need to analyze this data!" she was excited "Some life form trying to communicate! This is so cool!"

They went back to work on it when her communicator rang. Caught it with her hair:

"Hey! How are you?"

"Entrapta!" it was Bow who called "The princesses are holding an event for our victory. You do not come?"

"I'm very busy! I just caught some waves and I need to trace their origin!"

"But we only won because of you! You need to be here!"

“Look, I appreciate it, but I'm not good with social interactions, and besides, I have… company."

"Is it the Wrong Hordak? He also helped us, the girls won't mind if you want to bring him!"

“Well, it's not just him…” she looked back, then back to the communicator. “I can't keep it a secret. The real Hordak is here too."

"What?" Bow jumped "Are you serious?"

"He doesn't want to enslave Etheria anymore and I needed a helper, he..." she lowered her head "he's always been good to me..."

"But he's Hordak!"

"Catra had another chance, and I think she's done some pretty bad things..."

Bow put his hand to his forehead in disbelief. He took a deep breath, he could even understand her side, after all, when it came to friendship he was an expert.

“Listen, if he behaves, you can bring him with you. I'm going to talk to the Queen Glimmer about it." he smiled "We'll even make small meals for the party, you'll like it."

“But I'm in the middle of research!"

“Take a day off, your things will still be there when you get back."

"They'll still be here…" she said, thoughtfully "That's great! Thank you, Bow! See you at the party!"

She hung up, turned to her colleagues:

"We're going to have some social interaction!" She clapped

"That sounds magnificent to me!" -Wrong Hordak smiled "And how does it work?"

“We're going to Bright Moon, where the princesses are, we're going to try to have a conversation that's pleasant and not awkward at all, and in the meantime..." she picked up an antenna with his hair “we can try to trace the signal! According to the data, it is stronger in that direction!"

"Do you want to join the Princesses?" Hordak asked, a little annoyed.

"You were given permission to come with me! Let's just try to enjoy the party while we study. I think the Bow is right, the signal is still here, we just need to find it! And why not do it while we're at an extravagant event?"

He looked thoughtful, while the other clone was super excited, Hordak felt he wouldn't be welcome, but if they could pick up such a signal, it wouldn't be a total waste of time.

“Then I think we're going to this event."

"Perfect!" She smiled "I just need to change clothes!"

"What's wrong with yours?" he asked

“Well, nothing, but what I've studied about this type of event is that people have proper attire so they can blend in with others. I think you could try too."

"Shall we mingle?" Wrong Hordak smiled "It will be magnificent! Like when I mixed with my other brothers and nobody knew who I was!"

"Uh… I think so." laughed Entrapta. "Then everyone will get ready for the ball! Will be cool!"

Hordak wasn't quite sure about that, but he trusted her.

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Meanwhile, Bow paced around, searching for the right words to tell King Micah and Queen Glimmer that he had invited Hordak, former commander of the Horde, to the Princesses' celebration party.

"Where was my head?" he said, frustrated.

"Some problem?" Adora appeared in the hallway.

"I'm glad you came, I need some advice!"

"I don't know if I'm the most suitable, but you can talk."

"I invited Entrapta to the party..."

"And she's not coming?"

"Yes, she comes, she actually seemed excited about the idea..."

"So what ails you?"

"She's going to bring Hordak here!"

"The Wrong Hordak?"

"Both! The Wrong and the usual! The one who was always attacking us and tried to kill us!"

“This can't be serious!"

"I couldn't say no, because if we've already accepted Scorpia and Catra, we need to be good friends and accept Hordak too, don't we?"

"Bow!"

"Entrapta is smart, even in a kind of innocent way, she knows who he is and what he did, in fact, she helped him attack us... But it's

also because of her that the chipped people were saved! She deserves to be here as much as any of us!"

“I agree, Entrapta is our friend, we left her behind once, we can't do it again, but Hordak? What if he meets Catra? What if they start fighting in the middle of the party?"

"I need to tell Glimmer, but I don't think she's going to like it either..."

"Well, she was on the ship, saw what happened to him, maybe changed..."

"Do you really think so?"

“Or we can keep an eye on them all the time at the party. Does Glimmer need to know?"

"Adora!"

"It's fine, it's fine. Let's tell her. We owe it to Entrapta. If she's made new friends, we need to trust her."

Boa nodded, then they entered the throne room. Glimmer was with her father, showing him how much the realm had changed since he left, but they still avoided talking about Queen Angela. They turned when they heard the door open, the girl cracked a smile:

"Bow! Adora! I'm glad you came!"

"We needed to talk to you..." the boy said a little awkwardly.

"Then, now I'm showing Bright Moon to my father! This ball needs to be perfect, it's the consolidation of our alliance with the other kingdoms, we're finally at peace and nothing can spoil that!"

"Glimmer..." Adora began.

“Oh, don't worry." She interrupted "Catra will be welcome, after all, she saved my life and... Well, her help was essential."

"But Glimmer..." Archer tried

"I need to see if everything is going according to plan! Frosta is going to make some ice statues with the help of Mermista, Perfuma is arranging the flowers with Scorpia, everyone is excited!" She was running around the room happily. She turned to them. "Have you managed to reach Entrapta?"

They looked at each other. The guy scratched his head:

"Yes, and she will come, but..."

“Then they will all be here." She sighed

“Like old times." King Micah said “All kingdoms united. I'm proud of you, my daughter. Your mother would be too."

Glimmer's eyes widened, she really wanted her to be there, to know of her victory. She took a deep breath:

"I'll walk around. Will you come with me?"

They nodded, not really knowing how to get into the matter. She was too busy with the event, they thought it best to tell her later. To cheer her up, they helped her choose a suitable dress. Bow would be his date this time, unlike the previous Ball. Adora invited Catra to go with her, as Scorpia would be with Perfuma. She ended up accepting it, but she had a bad feeling about it, Melog could feel it too.

Unexpected Guests

The dance seemed under control at first, Perfuma gave Scorpia confidence, encouraged her to sing, just as they did while looking for the Peekablue. Catra stayed in the corner, watching them. She wore the same suit from the last ball.

“You look very beautiful." Adora praised her, smiling.

“It's the same as the other time." She turned her face a little red.

"I didn't have notice the other time, since... You know... I had to watch you."

“That was fun." Catra smiled "The best part was the note I threw in the trash to prank you, you should have seen your face." She started laughing

The blonde didn't deny it, although she had been nervous at the time, now it was funny. They laughed together, but Catra's gaze remained on Scorpia, she wore a black dress, while Perfuma wore a green one.

'What are you worried about?" Adora asked. "You're not going to tell me you're jealous of Scorpia."

"Of course not!" She turned her face "I just think this little princess with flowers is a show off, she thinks she knows Scorpia better than I do."

“So you're jealous." The blonde flashed a smirk.

"Shut up."

“Listen, making new friends doesn't mean abandoning old ones."

"So you say that to me." She rolled her eyes.

“After all I've been through with Bow and Glimmer, I still want to be here with you." Adora put her hands on her shoulders "What happened, happened. I love you, Catra. And Scorpia too, that's for sure."

She sighed. This friendship thing was even harder than She imagined.

“Let's say hi to them." Adora took her hand, inviting her "Perfume is cool, you can get along."

Glimmer and Bow were at the buffet table. They hadn't had much time to be alone since the war ended, but the boy was still thinking about Entrapta and his new "friends".

"Did something happen?" the queen asked. "You're not usually so quiet."

“I'm fine, just… thinking."

"I know, we've been through so much..." she sighed "sometimes I can't believe it's finally over either..."

The boy smiled to see her so calm, as she hadn't been for a long time. He wish he could keep her like this forever, happy, in peace. A movie played in his mind, best friends forever, since he joined the rebellion without his parents knowing, then they met Adora, they were more united than ever, Glimmer always knew his true self, understood and supported him, gave him strength when his parents learned the truth. In every important moment, she was there with him, from princess to her rise as Queen of Bright Moon.

“I love you, Glimmer." He said aloud

She was a little surprised, as it seemed very sudden, but hugged him, smiling:

“I love you too, Bow."

He hugged her tight, he wanted to protect her from everything, from the world, from evil, but he couldn't hide anything from her:

"I need to tell you something..."

She was looking at him with her big bright eyes, he had all her attention, until they heard Sea Hawk call the princesses, he had a microphone in his hands:

"My companions, I want a minute of attention for the song that I will dedicate to the woman of my life, Princess Mermista!"

She put her hands to covering her face. She thought he was a jerk, but he was also cute. Their relationship was a little troubled, because she didn't hate him, although she did a lot to deserve it. She knew he was just euphoric, flustered and that he loved to set fire to boats, but when she needed help, he was the first one to show up for her, even if it was with crazy ideas of a fake kidnapping. The hall danced to its music, Bow felt as if everything was in slow motion, every step they took, the way their bodies moved to the beat, he caught a glimpse of Adora and Catra, the two of them looking so good together. He could have been worrying for nothing, it was a dance, a moment to relax, to enjoy, but as soon as he took a deep breath, the door opened, paralyzing everything:

"Hey guys! Hope I'm not too late!"

It was Entrapta, dressed in a purple suit, accompanied by Emily, who wore a bow tie, to her left Wrong Hordak was wearing a white suit, and to her right, Hordak in a black suit, holding a device in one hand.

Everyone turned towards them, some apprehensive, others nervous:

"What's he doing here?" Glimmer summoned her staff, but Bow grabbed her arm.

"That's what I meant! Entrapta is with Hordak... and not just the Wrong Hordak..."

"Did you know that?" she asked irritably. "That could jeopardize the entire security of the kingdom! He's not welcome here!"

"I know you're angry, and you're right to be, but if he's with Entrapta, I think we owe her a vote of confidence..."

"This is a joke? What's this guy doing here?" Catra yelled.

"Catra..." Adora tried to grab her arm, but she pulled it away.

"Don't tell me they've forgiven him!"

"Catra, calm down!" Scorpia approached her "I know this situation is pretty weird, but he's with Entrapta, we need to be good friends and support her!"

"Have you forgotten what he put us through? What did he put me through?"

"No, I also have my reasons for not liking him, like the fact that he induced my family to join the Horde and take the Dark Crystal that is rightfully mine, but we know Entrapta and we know she's not evil."

"Scorpia!"

"And I think you owe her…" she scratched her head "I mean, it's none of my business, but she interceded for you to go to the Crimson Waste, I was told she removed your chip, and also… Good. .. After that portal thing..."

"I get it, you can stop." She replied irritated "I just want him away from me."

Mermista turned away, she wouldn't so easily accept seeing the one who dominated her lands walking through the front door, even accompanied by the geek princess. Frosta was more direct,

made her fists of ice and went for Hordak, only to be stopped because Perfuma tied her with her roots:

"Don't make any sudden movements! We don't know what he's going to do!"

"Is this how people interact?" Wrong Hordak asked.

"I have no idea!" laughed Entrapta "but knowing these princesses, probably!" She waved "Hi Adora! Catra! Scorpia! I'm happy to see you!" She turned to the buffet table "Thank you for inviting us, Bow!"

Glimmer looked at him:

"What did she mean? Have you gone crazy?"

“In my defense, I invited her and said she could bring escorts, technically I didn't invite a former Horde leader and his seemingly friendly clone."

"The Wrong Hordak may stay, but the real one will have to leave!" She teleported closer to them.

"Queen Glimmer!" the animated clone greeted her "I think the custom is to say that it is an honor to be here!" he winked

"What's he doing here?" She pointed at the man in the dark robes.

"He is helping me with my research!" Entrapta kept the smile, not realizing the tension it caused in everyone "You will be surprised by my discovery!"

The little device Hordak was carrying began to beep:

"What is it? A bomb?" Glimmer jumped back

"No, it's a-" Entrapta began, but was interrupted.

"For the honor of Grayskull!" Adora had transformed, drew her sword and stood in front of the queen "What's your plan? I thought I wouldn't try to dominate Etheria again!"

He arched an eyebrow, ended up sketching a smile:

“It's curious to think that I could have invaded Bright Moon so easily."

“Hordak,” called Entrapta. “I have to explain to them about the device, they don't understand what happens so easily, I learned from Catra."

"Explain yourself!" ordered Glimmer.

She-ra's presence made the device beep even faster.

"As I thought! A connection with the First Ones!" Entrapta was very excited.

"What is happening?" Catra asked

Hordak just tossed the device in the air, without explaining much of what he was doing. The ball was in chaos, the princesses in battle stance, Entrapta was too euphoric to realize the mess she'd gotten herself into, so the object fell silent.

"Uh…" Bow took a few steps forward "what is supposed to happen?"

A few minutes of silence, then a strong light came out of the device, where a female voice was heard:

"Glimmer?"

She soon shorted out and blacked out. Entrapta hugged Hordak and spun around:

" It worked out! I was right!"

No one else understood what it was, but the queen was in shock, as she recognized the voice as soon as she heard it:

"Was it... my mother?"

"How it is possibili?" asked She-ra.

"Queen Angela?" asked Bow

"Someone has to explain now what just happened!" said Catra, crossing her arms.

"We've picked up a signal from another dimension!" Entrapta jumped for joy "Queen Angela is alive!"

Glimmer dropped her staff, dropped to her knees:

"My mother..."

King Micah was not present in the mess, taking a tour of the castle. He saw the crowd gathered in the hall, his daughter on her knees beside Hordak, ran to him:

"What do you want here? What did they do to my little girl?"

"Calm down, Your Majesty!" said Bow. "They... They're on our side..."

The king extended his hand to his daughter, helping her up:

"What did they do?"

"They... They found my mother... Alive..." She replied

"Angela?" He widened his eyes, surprised. Turned to them "Where is she? Can you bring her here?"

“We are studying that possibility." said Entrapta. "I can try to create a portal, safer than the previous one and that doesn't completely destroy reality."

"Do it." said the king

"Dad!" called Glimmer. "That can be very dangerous! I don't want to risk losing anyone else..."

"Don't worry!" Said Entrapta "At first, let's just establish communication. Now that she knows we know she's there, I imagine she'll keep trying too."

"But why are you with Hordak?" Glimmer asked, raising her fists.

“Because he understands me, he's my friend. Isn't?" She looked at him, smiling.

He coughed covertly, looking away.

“She is a princess unlike any other. Your intellectual capacity is greater than anyone else's in this room.

"We've all become friends!" Wrong Hordak smiled. "Now that the great Horde Prime is gone, my brothers are free from your control!"

“The Hordak got rid of the original's body." said Entrapta. “I can't do it without him.” She brushed her hair over his shoulder.

The princesses looked from one to the other, a little perplexed.

“I think we have to debate this in the boardroom." said Glimmer

"But we were at the party!" said Swift Wind

"Are you really going to believe this?" asked Catra

“We can discuss after the Ball." suggested Adora.

"And are we just going to proceed as if nothing is happening?" asked Glimmer

“I think everyone needs to calm down." Perfuma said "This event promotes peace and unity, let's not spoil it by fighting."

“She's right." agreed Scorpia.

"You can only be kidding." said Catra

"I prefer to withdraw." Mermista turned her back "Do as you wish."

"But darling..." began the Seahawk.

“Princess Geek has already chosen which friends she prefers, I think I'd better go back to Salineas and make sure they won't be attacked in my absence again. You come with me?"

"Yes my princess."

She left the hall, annoyed. She valued Entrapta's efforts and her actions during the war, but she would not be in the same place as Hordak.

The rest were still staring at each other, apprehensive. Although Adora tried to calm Catra, she also didn't take her eyes off the former Horde commander.

"So this is how parties work?" asked Wrong Hordak

"Entrapta!" Bow called "How about if you and the Hordaks come to eat something, then I can try to help you with your research, what do you think?”

"What are you doing?" whispered Glimmer

“I'll watch over them." he replied in a low voice. "If they try anything, I'll give you a sign."

"Great idea!" Entrapta smiled "I'm starving!" She tied hee hair in the hands of the Hordaks, pulling them "let's eat! They even made the small dishes which I love!"

They approached the table. Wrong Hordak looked around, trying to imitate what she did. He thought Etheria's food was really

good. The princesses tried to return to music, to dancing, but their eyes would not leave him. It would be a long night.

Meeting Room

The dance tried to go as normal as possible, Bow tried to be a good friend and support Entrapta, but he couldn't blame Mermista for leaving. He was dancing surreptitiously watching them when he noticed the Wrong Hordak trying to imitate his movements, so he extended his hand.

"Do you wanna Dance?"

The clone looked at him and his hand:

"Dance?"

“Just feel the music, move your body. Is not difficult." the boy smiled

He moved his ears, closed his eyes, listening to the music, moved his arms and legs as Bow had done a short time ago and smiled:

“I think I'm getting this pointless ritual you called dancing."

"It's going well!" He got excited, forgetting what he was doing "I'll teach you some steps, follow me!"

Glimmer goes from far Bow to dance with Wrong Hordak, slapped his forehead:

“He really is an expert at making friends."

Entrapta and Hordak walked around the hall, watching everything. They didn't seem to be doing anything wrong, but they still couldn't let their guard down. Perfuma was still with Scorpia, dancing:

"You must be a little uncomfortable with him here, don't you?" asked the flower princess.

“It's a little weird, but Entrapta has always gotten along great with him and is one of my best friends, so it's okay."

"And you think they're really going to find Queen Angela?"

Scorpia looked at the two of them, then sketched a smile:

“If anyone can do that, it's definitely her." She took a deep breath "I hope the mermaid princess is okay..."

"Are you talking about Mermista?" Asked Perfuma "She's a little temperamental, but she will... The Seahawk can cheer her up, he's a good friend."

Catra and Adora also watched, saw Bow get distracted by the clone, decided to act on their own:

“We'll cover more area if we split up." said Catra

“But we will raise suspicions." replied the blonde "Let's dance, so it will be the perfect disguise."

"Uuh, are you asking me to dance?" Catra laughed in debauchery.

Adora cracked a smile and pulled her close to her body:

"Maybe."

The cat put a hand on her shoulder and the other on her waist:

"Nice disguise. Let's see if you can keep up with me!"

They went to the center of the hall, at first keeping their attention on Hordak, but as the music played, their eyes met. When was the last time they both had a moment of peace together? That dance was the perfect opportunity, their bodies led by the music, their touches in the dance, Catra gripped Adora's waist tighter as they spun together, her legs took steps in the same rhythm, as if it had been rehearsed, they let the moment guided, enveloped by the sound.

Entrapta went on to observe her friends:

“It seems that dancing is a common thing on this occasion."

"Is that what humans usually do at these events?" Hordak raised an eyebrow.

“Look over there, even the Wrong Hordak is enjoying himself!" she offered the tip of her pigtails "Do you want to try this experiment with me?"

He was a little stunned, so he grabbed her hair:

"I agreed to study social interactions, I think that's part of it."

"So lets dance!" She pulled him with her hair, he didn't know exactly what to do with his hands, since she was never a fan of physical contact, he kept a certain distance.

Glimmer was in the corner, arms crossed, watching.

"Aren't you going with your friends?" asked King Micah.

“Bow has already found another pair." She turned her face "I don't know how they manage to go on as if nothing is happening!"

“I don't like his presence here either, but if he know how to get my Angela back, we'll allow him to stay. After all, they let the Shadow Weaver stay too, didn't they?"

Glimmer lowered her head. He was right, trusting Shadow Weaver always caused a lot of conflict with Adora, although in the end she sacrificed herself for her, but Hordak was different, she had no reason to believe he was really good. The king put his hand on her shoulder:

“Being queen means making difficult decisions."

"Do you think Mom would have let them stay?"

“If it was to save you, yes." He smiled "Now let's have some fun, okay?"

She smiled back, her father was right. Her mother first.

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When the dance ended, everyone was summoned to the meeting room. Entrapta and the Hordaks would be seated where everyone could see, as any strange acts would be quickly contained. King Micah had bewitched the room, no one went in or out without permission.

“You have the word." said the king

"Shouldn't we wait for Mermista to come back?" asked Bow

"We do not have time." said Glimmer. "We'll call her when we have evidence it's safe."

The king gestured to Entrapta, waiting for her to explain her plan.

“Very well,” she began. “We were running around the castle looking for a better signal. With those little seconds where she answered us, it gave us a good clue where she is. You won't believe it!" she said excitedly. "Tell them, Hordak!"

“I know this location." He said in a serious tone "It's called Eternia."

"It's not amazing?" Entrapta was agitated "This is not the first time that a portal there has been opened, it has happened before!"

"What does that mean?" asked Adora

"That's where you come from!" replied Entrapta. "Your family, your origins! If we can get hold of Queen Angela, we might as well find your family!"

Adora was silent, stunned. Catra got up from her chair:

"What are you talking about?"

“Adora was taken from her home when we attacked Eternia many years ago. The time has come to make amends for all I have done in the name of the Horde Prime."

"Do you think we're idiots?" Catra slammed her hand on the table "We have no guarantee that this is true, do we, Adora? Adora?"

The blonde was silent, her eyes wide, she brought her hands to her mouth, trembling.

"Adora?" Bow called

"I... I need some time..." She rose from her chair, King Micah let her out of the hall, Swift Wind followed her.

"Adora, what happened?"

"I want to be alone!"

"Well, I can feel what you feel, I don't know if it's worth avoiding..."

"Well, I can feel what you feel, I don't know if it's worth avoiding..."

"Swift Wind, it's about my parents! I never knew anything about them or myself, I grew up in the Horde thinking I did the right thing, until I found out it was all a lie. I finally found myself as She-ra and now they're saying I can find my family?"

"Adora..."

"What if they don't want to see me? What if they never tried to look for me? What if they're bad people and I was meant to be evil?"

“Adora, nothing you say makes sense. Calm down!"

"Light Hope already told me that it was she who brought me, but now she doesn't even exist anymore! Her program was disabled when we stopped the Heart of Etheria... So why now?"

“We don't know how long they've been looking for you. Suddenly it was Queen Angela who told them that you were still alive, and for that reason they only got it now."

"I don't know how to feel about this..."

“I'm honestly happy for you. You are the heroine of Etheria, take it as a gift from such an ungrateful fate."

"A gift..." she was thoughtful "You're right, I've always wanted my answers, I can finally get them!" She hugged the horse "Thank you, Swift Wind. I feel better."

"Now let's go back to the living room. Someone should really put up chairs for the horses, I have some great advice to give."

She laughed, the equine has always been very optimistic. She returned to the meeting room, everyone had a worried look, but she calmed them down:

“I'm fine, I want to know what else you guys found out."

“Based on our knowledge of opening interdimensional portals, we're going to need the First Ones' technology and She-ra's sword."

"But isn't it dangerous?" asked Scorpia "I mean, last time…" she was trying to avoid looking at Catra, but the cat noticed.

“I'll stay the hell away, if that's what you're worried about."

"I did not want to..."

"It's all right. That's none of my business.” she said in an irritated tone.

Adora stared at her, saying nothing. She needed to rethink what it could all mean, what would happen if they found their true family.

"Very well." said King Micah. "You can do your studies and the necessary tests, but he will always be watched. You can't take a step through this castle or anywhere in Bright Moon without being accompanied by a guard or someone we trust."

Hordak didn't answer, it was as he'd expected. It didn't faze him, in fact, the Etherians' opinion of him didn't matter, his only interest was to work side by side with Entrapta once again.

“If the meeting is over, I will withdraw." said Glimmer

"I'll go with you!" Bow got up.

"Adora?" she called "can you accompany us?"

"Oh yes. Everything is fine." the blonde followed them

They went to the queen's room, sat on the raised bed:

“I feel uncomfortable with this idea." said Bow. "Are we going to help Hordak make a portal? Is this serious?"

“I have my doubts too, but we don't have a better plan. My mother is there on the other side, somewhere!"

"But it's Hordak!" Bow said, scared.

“Listen, I'm nervous too, but…” Adora put her hands to her body. “What if I really get to meet my parents?"

They were silent for a moment:

"Adora..." said Glimmer putting her hands on her shoulder "I... I've been selfish... I've only thought about my mother..."

"It's OK..." She said

"It is not!" said Bow. "You two just want your families! I haven't been thinking straight..."

“No one here trusts Hordak. You're right,” Adora said. "The last portal nearly destroyed us, but..."

"But?"

"But if I came from another dimension, this 'Eternia' thing, then someone already made a portal before it worked!"

"Adora..."

“I trust Entrapta, and that's what I'll keep in mind. As King Micah said, Hordak will always be watched."

Bow smiled:

“It's a bad idea, in classic Best Friends Forever style."

The three of them laughed, felt a little better, even though this vote of confidence was incredibly risky.

Revealed Truths

The research was going well, they were using a room as a laboratory while they transferred the Entrapta things that were left in the Fright Zone, they fixed some parts together, sitting at the table. Hordak could remember a few things he had done in the past that would be useful in opening the portal. It wasn't as if he regretted everything he'd accomplished over the years, but he blamed himself for the reasons. He should have known from the start that the Horde Prime would never accept him as an equal, as a brother. All he did was for an unattainable approval, an impossible dream. When he looked at Entrapta's face, he realized how much none of this mattered anymore, she accepted him with his imperfections, helped him when he needed it, without her nothing would be possible.

"Some problem?" She lifted her protective mask.

“No, none." He turned his face

"Oh, okay." She went back to work, lowering the mask "You were staring at me for a long time, I thought I had done something wrong." She said as she soldered some wires.

“You never do anything wrong." He replied so automatically that he almost didn't realize it, but she started to laugh.

“I make mistakes all the time. That's how science is done. First we find a problem, then we formulate a hypothesis, and then we test it. With the results we learn how to improve."

“Not everyone understands the beauty of technology the way you do."

“People tend to think I'm weird. I got used to it. Mermista even calls me "Geek Princess".

"The Princess of the Kingdom of Salineas?" he was thoughtful

"I understand that she's pretty pissed off about what happened, although she also seems pissed off all the time... I'm not very good with human emotions, machines are so much easier to deal with..."

“Emotions are what make them weak, vulnerable. This state should reflect directly on her Runestone."

Entrapta swiveled in her chair, went to the computer on the other side of the room:

"It's a hypothesis..." She said as he typed. "If we adapt the structure of the portal to work with the power of Etheria, using the Sword of Protection a key might not be as risky as last time."

Hordak got up, went to her to look at the screen:

“Etheria's magic is powerful, if used correctly." He commented "If the princesses are in harmony with their stones, we can use magic as a source for the portal."

"It would be perfect! We just need the Princesses in Harmony!" she was super excited "Combining their magic with our technology should be enough to bring Queen Angela back!"

“And send Adora back." he completed

She was silent, looking at him and the screen:

"What do you mean?"

“She doesn't belong on this planet. I imagine she want to return to where she came from."

"Well, logically yes, but..." she looked ahead "I think we have to ask her... I mean... If her sword is the key and she crosses, we don't know if she can come back..."

“She's not from here. To fix all the mistakes, I need to send her back."

“Let's think about it later." Entrapta swiveled back to the table "First we need the Princesses' harmony, so let's work on that."

The door opened, Wrong Hordak was accompanied by one of Bright Moon's guards, carrying a tray with mini breads and small cups of tea:

"I came to bring you a snack!" He smiled

“It's a good idea to take a break." Entrapta got up and went to him.

Hordak looked at the computer screen thoughtfully. He was determined to erase everything he had done in the Horde Prime's name.

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After several days, a new meeting was called, the presence of all the Princesses was requested, Mermista attended, even against her will. Seahawk spent these days trying to cheer her up, making her feel better, they even fought in a bar against other sailors who had their boats set on fire by the captain, but upon receiving the invitation from Bright Moon, her irritation returned:

"Are you really going to work with Hordak? And you want me to agree?"

“We're not exactly happy about it." Perfuma replied "I've seen many of my plants die because of him and his army, but they are growing back."

"It's not so bad." Scorpia said “I've worked with him since…well, forever. My grandfather allied with the Horde and they say he was a great man."

“Guys, let's not argue." said Glimmer. "He's been behaving here in the castle."

“Bright Moon doesn't even have a real prison." Mermista said “It's just a guest room.”

"Guys!" called Bow. "We're all on the same side here! And my parents have also studied hard to help. They were excited by the idea of a place called Eternia."

"Guys, where's Adora?" Frosta asked, looking around.

“She was with Catra. They've been spending a lot of time together…” Scorpia replied, head down.

“I'll go after them." Glimmer rose "she needs to be here."

Before anyone said anything, she had already teleported away. She searched every room.

Catra was sitting on the porch, watching the landscape. Adora accompany her:

"It's a beautiful place when you have time to enjoy the scenery." the blonde commented

"Is that why you stayed here? Because it's 'beautiful'?" Catra said

"No." She took a deep breath "I learned a lot since I left the Horde."

"After you left me..."

“I wish you had come with me, Catra."

“There's no place for me here."

“You helped me save Etheria, of course It has."

“Your little friends sure as hell don't think so. The Shining One and the Arrow Thrower maybe, but not the rest."

“The important thing is that you're trying, Catra. Nobody knows you like I do." She smiled, approached, placing her hand gently on

her face.

"Adora..."

They were close, but before they could seal their lips, Glimmer appeared:

"I found you! They are waiting for you in the meeting room!"

They turned to the Queen, Catra crossed her arms sullenly.

"Am I interrupting?" Glimmer asked

"You've already interrupted." Catra turned her back "you can go to your princess reunion."

"You do not come?" Adora asked

"And be in the same room with Hordak? No, thank you."

"But they might have found out more about me and where I came from! I... I need you with me!"

Catra's eyes widened, those words touched her heart deeply. She held her hand:

"Since you insist..."

"Excellent." said Glimmer impatiently.

She teleported the two of them to the meeting room.

Entrapta was already there, accompanied by the Hordaks. Bow's parents were also present, Lance was excited to share his findings:

"Adora! I'm glad you came!"

"Sorry for the delay..." She scratched her head, sat down at the table.

“I want to share what we've discovered about Eternia." he opened a computer on the table, creating images of space "It is a planet at the center of the universe, where all the power of creation is concentrated, also called 'The Fires of Eternity'."

"Incredible!" Entrapta's eyes gleamed.

"Legends say that here there is a castle that belonged to King Grayskull, it was called 'Castle Grayskull'."

Adora was speechless, as She-ra had always fought for the Honor of Grayskull, and now she could finally know what it was all about.

“We're still studying, but apparently he was responsible for forging two twin swords, The Sword of Power and the Sword of Protection. One of them was yours, Adora."

"And where's the other one?"

"In Eternia." replied Hordak. "With your brother."

Silence in the hall, Adora was frozen, the word "brother" seemed to her something so strange, so far away. Everyone looked at each other, not knowing what to say. Catra got up from her chair:

"How do you know?" she asked nervously. "What happened on Eternia?"

Hordak rose, the princesses were on alert:

“There is a Horde base on Eternia, at a place called Snake Mountain. It was with the Sword of Power that King Grayskull drove my army away."

"But you didn't even know Adora was She-ra!" replied Catra

“I didn't know at first who this soldier was." continued Hordak. "After her powers were revealed, I understood what had happened, but my memories are still a little messed up by the Horde Prime's interference."

"But it's not over yet!" Said Entrapta "We've figured out how to use a safe power source to open our portal!"

"That's great!" Perfume clapped her hands, smiling "They could have talked about this before!"

“We're going to combine our technology with that of the First Ones, so the Elemental Princesses connect with their runestones. With the help of a powerful sorcerer, any possible anomaly will be contained!"

“Shadow Weaver would be perfect for that." said Hordak. "But she is no longer with us."

Catra lowered her head, drooped her ears. She never understood the sacrifice, why it took her so long to say she was proud of her, something she'd wanted to hear since childhood.

"I can do this." said King Micah. "If I'm going to bring Angela, I'm in."

"Dad, it's dangerous..." said Glimmer.

"For you too." Bow put his hand over hers "They're going to need all the Princesses, including you..."

"And will they just accept it?" Mermista asked "the last time the princesses connected we almost died!"

"But it will be different now!" Said Entrapta "We can monitor the energy released! It's our best chance to find Queen Angela!"

"Mermista..." Perfuma put her hand on her shoulder, trying to calm her 'We're all together. Nothing bad will happen."

"And if it does, we'll punch him!" Frosta made her fists of ice, directing them at the Hordak.

"Guys, this is crazy!" said Catra. "Are you really going to do that?"

“Whatever it takes for my mother." replied Glimmer

Mermista shrugged, she wouldn't object, she also wanted to save Queen Angela. Perfuma and Scorpia seemed to have accepted the idea well, Frosta was glad her presence was important. Adora was still silent, too much information to process.

"Then," Entrapta rose to his feet, "if everyone is in agreement, we will proceed with our studies." turned to King Micah "can your majesty accompany us? We need to analyze your magic for the portal to be compatible."

He nodded, one by one the princesses rose from their chairs and walked out of the hall with the exception of Glimmer, Bow, and Catra. Adora was still motionless, the word "brother" echoing in her mind. Not long ago she didn't know anything about her past, and now she's discovered a brother with a sword like hers in a place called Grayskull.

"Hey, Adora!" Catra called to her, waving her hand in front of her face "What happened to you?"

"I... I think I need to see Madame Razz..."

"Who?"

"She lives in the forest... She... She met Mara..."

"Adora!" Glimmer called "I think you should rest first..."

"She's right! You've been through too much,” said Bow

"You don't understand…" she shook her head. "You've always known who your parents were… Bow, what's it like to have brothers? It's very weird? Do you keep in communication with them? Are any of them also an archer and have you always felt a strange connection to your bow not knowing it was possibly from having a brother with a bow like yours?"

"Adora calm down!" He put his hands on her shoulder "Brothers are like friends, people you can trust. Are you worried that he might not like you?"

"What? Pff, no." she was agitated "Why would I worry? Just because I disappeared without ever being able to send news of anything and suddenly we're going to open a portal to my house?"

Catra's eyes widened, she hadn't stopped to think about it before:

"Your... home..." She said in a low voice.

She felt that Adora might be tempted to leave, to go back to her origins. She didn't even want to imagine losing her again, not after everything they'd been through.

"Sorry..." said the blonde "I must look completely crazy... You're right, I need to rest." She rose from the chair "I'm going to my room. If you need anything, call me."

She walked out the door, but even lying on her bed, her mind wouldn't stop.

"Brother..." She said aloud, as if trying to get used to the idea, but everything was new and confusing. It no longer had the original sword, destroyed it when Light Hope tried to activate the Heart of Etheria, however, it was not lost forever. Even lying on her bed, she stretched her arm up, concentrating, her new sword came out. She just wanted to look at her.

"Eternia... Grayskull... Brother..." she repeated, took a deep breath as she saw her own reflection in the blade "What do I do?"

Catra was behind the door unbeknownst to Adora, hearing every word between her sighs. She decided not to go in, as much as it hurt the idea of losing her again, she just wanted to be happy, after all, she herself told her once to think a little more about herself. She turned her back, wouldn't interfere.

Conflicts and Conversations

King Micah accompanied Entrapta on her tests, Hordak continued to be watched, though he showed no desire to dominate Bright Moon. The king was curious about the clone, affectionately called "Wrong Hordak", as it had a totally different personality, much more cheerful and friendly.

"It's almost ready!" Entrapta was excited "Let's summon the princesses!"

"Do you think it will work?" The King arched an eyebrow.

"The imminent dangers have been neutralized, we just need to connect to the energy of the Elemental Princesses and the Sword of She-ra!

"Then I'll call them to a meeting." The King walked to the door without taking his eyes off Hordak. "Don't leave here. Someone will come and bring them something to eat."

"I can do this!" Wrong Hordak smiled "Cooking was a skill I learned!"

"I'd rather you stay here." replied King Micah, then left.

He knew he had been away for many years, yet he was no fool to trust Hordak. The little he knew about Entrapta while they were on the Beast Island made him understand that she was a very intelligent person, at the same time she was the one who stole her food, so it was difficult to trust her. He took a deep breath, he had already been naive once to believe in Shadow Weaver, he couldn't let anyone else manipulate him.

A meeting with the Princesses was called, guided to the room/prison/laboratory where the portal tests were done. Bow went along with Glimmer, wanting to make sure nothing bad happened to her. Wrong Hordak waved and blinked at the sight of them, the boy waved back. Adora didn't know where Catra was,

since the last meeting when she'd heard about her brother she'd felt more distant, but just now that she was so close, the cat seemed to be gone. The princesses were waiting for her, she couldn't be distracted as it affected her She-ra powers.

In the laboratory, Entrapta had marked on the floor the place where each princess should stand, making a circle. In the center of it the portal would open. Swift Wind insisted on taking part, but at the moment the scientist didn't think it was necessary, as the Sword would be the key.

Wires were connected to King Micah to catalyze his magic.

"And what do we do?" Mermista asked disdainfully, her arms crossed.

“Activate the power of your runestones." replied Hordak.

They all just stared at him if he said nothing.

“That thing where you all shine." explained Entrapta

"Oh."

They closed their eyes, not sure how they activated it, but according to Bow, it was the "power of friendship".

The machine began to react, King Micah concentrated to keep the magic steady, but something didn't feel right. Adora had her sword, she was facing it, but her thoughts were still on Catra.

"Adora!" Entrapta called "Raise the Sword! Are you not listening to me?"

"What?" She seemed to have woken up from his daydreams "Oh, sorry. For the Honor of Grayskull!"

She transformed into She-ra, with her white and gold robes, long hair pulled back in a ponytail, her tiara, and increased physical stature. Her sword resonated with something on the other side, as

if she could hear someone calling her name, but even with King Micah's efforts, the portal failed to form for long, the lights went out and the princesses fell to their knees, exhausted. :

"Any more brilliant ideas?" Mermista asked, annoyed.

"I don't understand..." Entrapta scratched her head "Something went wrong..."

"Maybe we should focus more." said Perfume

"Or someone wasn't paying enough attention." Frosta turned to She-ra.

"Do you think it's my fault?" the blonde asked "I'm the most interested here! It's my house we're talking about"

"Adora, calm down!" said Glimmer "but if something's bothering you, you might as well let us know so we can sort it out."

"I don't know where Catra is...", she replied, crestfallen.

"She went to take a nap." Scorpia replied. "It's in my room that used to be a prison."

"How long has she been there?" Adora went to the big one and put her hands on her shoulders "Did something happen to her? I did something?"

"Calm down, you don't have to be like this!" Scorpia took a few steps back "I think it was the idea of you having another life that messed with her, she just asked to go to sleep and not be bothered by anything, so... Well, then I didn't wake her..."

"But if it had worked, shouldn't she be here to see it?" asked Perfume

"Why do you care so much about her?" Mermista asked irritated "Have you guys forgotten everything she did to us? Of everything the Horde has done?"

"I haven't forgotten..." Glimmer clenched her fist, "But I can't worry about that right now, I just want to bring my mother back... Whatever the cost..."

"Guys..." Bow began. "I think before we try again we need to sit down and talk.You know, keep the 'princess harmony'"

"The Bow is right!" Said Entrapta analyzing the computer "Your stress levels were too high, they need to be okay for this to work!"

"Is it really necessary?" Hordak raised an eyebrow.

“It's a hypothesis." She smiled, he couldn't say no to that.

“Then you can get right, then we'll get back to testing." He turned his back, two royal guards went after him to keep an eye on him.

"Very well." Bow took the floor "Everyone sit down, let's take advantage of the fact that they are in a circle to talk about it."

“I have nothing more to say than what I've already said." Mermista crossed her arms.

"I think Catra should come too..." suggested Scorpia.

“I'll go get her." Glimmer transported to her room.

"Wait Glim... Forget it." Bow sighed

It didn't take long to get back, the cat was annoyed:

“What's your problem, Spark? I told no one to disturb me!" She looked around, all the princesses were looking at her "Great. "She said with irony "meeting of the clubhouse."

“Let's all calm down first." Perfuma said "How about we recite a mantra together?"

"I'm in!" Scorpia replied. "This is really very good."

"And since when do you do this sort of thing?" asked Catra suspiciously.

“Since the time we were after the Peekablue that later turned out to be Double Trouble. "She smiled "I repeat to myself that 'I can do it, I can do it', gives me a little more confidence."

"This is not going to work." complained Catra

"We will try." Perfume clasped her palms, conveyed a lot of peace "get in touch with your inner self to find the source of this anger."

"I do not need." Mermista said “My anger comes from Salineas being attacked while we were made of idiots looking for blame for a failed mission. Made us go around in circles!"

"And what do you expect now?" asked Catra "Do you want an apology? We were at war, I was only conquering territories in the name of the Horde! I'm not that Catra anymore."

"And you think just saying that is enough? Mermista said nervously" “My people suffered! How many were not killed in the attack? How many did not have to take refuge? They don't live so well out of water! I don't even know why I agreed to join the rebellion!"

Glimmee felt sick to hear that, as if some of the blame had fallen on her.

“I fixed your shield with my powers." Adora said “We helped you, that's why you joined us."

“And after that they just made me walk through the sewers of the Fright Zone!"

“You've done more than that, Mermista." said Glimmer. "Your help was essential for us to win!"

"And we work well together!" Frosta said “My kingdom tried to remain neutral, but with the Horde's attacks, we saw rebellion as

the best option. And I was happy to be useful and fight alongside you!"

"Mermista," said Bow, "is there a way for them to make up for what they've done? Because now Cat is on our side, and apparently so is Hordak."

“I could think about it." She answered

"So that's all it is?" asked Catra "You tell me what you want, I'll do it and you leave what happened behind?"

"It's a start." Mermista shrugged "If you're really willing to prove that we can trust you."

“If this meeting is over, then I'm leaving." Catra stood up, but Adora grabbed her arm.

"There's something else..."

The cat took a deep breath. It was too easy.

"What do you want?"

"Are you mad at me for something?" asked the blonde

“I'm not going to discuss this in front of the other princesses."

"Then admit you're..." Adora lowered her head.

"Why don't you tell her?" Scorpia said "You need to talk..."

"That's nobody's business!" Catra said angrily "Or do you even care?"

"What do you mean?" asked Perfuma

"You're about to open a portal to send Adora away! Did they still not understand?"

They all looked confused:

"What do you mean?" the blonde asked

“You're going to abandon me again, I know that. You'll be able to stay with your family, your... Your brother! Then you will leave us, an exchange for Queen Angela!"

“We would never do that!" said Glimmer

"You're willing to do anything for your mother!" Catra continued "And already used the Adora as bait once to make a surprise attack against the Horde!"

"Guys, calm down!" Adora yelled. "Whether I go home or not, it's my decision! I do not intend to abandon you!" She turned to Catra "Why didn't you say you were worried about it?"

"You already left me behind once..." she turned her face away. .

“Catra…” Adora sighed, put her hands on her face, looked into her heterochromatic eyes. “I never wanted to leave you, and I promise it won't happen again. I just want to meet my family, know where I came from. You can come with me!"

"Adora..."

“I love you, Catra. I need you to tell me when something's wrong."

The cat hugged her. She hadn't completely gotten over her abandonment issues, but feeling her in her arms comforted her.

"Do not leave me please..."

“I promise I won't." She hugged back "I don't want you to leave me either."

Bowr's eyes sparkled, he thought it was all really cute, then he got up:

"I think they've resolved it now, don't you?' That is great!"

"So can we try again?" asked Entrapta excitedly.

The princesses nodded. Mermista looked at Catea, in Adora's arms she really seemed to have changed. She sighed, she wouldn't forgive her until Salineas prospered again, but she was willing to take that chance.

A New Try

The Princesses took some time to rest. Glimmer was thoughtful about Catra's words. She wouldn't think of sacrificing Adora for her mother, it was absurd. She wanted to believe that she wouldn't lose anyone else if everything went right.

King Micah followed after Hordak, who was accompanied by two guards. He looked harmless, studying the flowers in the garden.

The king watched him, curious. In fact, he didn't remember the garden being like that, he hadn't visited it in years.

“They seem to be from the Shadow Weaver" Hordak commented

"What did you say?" The King raised his fists.

"The flowers." He replied “There was a time when she betrayed me and decided to help the rebellion." He picked a purple flower "I've seen Bright Moon's 'prisons', probably she took care of this garden with her own hands."

“She was Light Spinner before she joined you." The man turned his face, also admiring the flowers.

“She was very powerful. You're probably only alive because of her." Hordak twirled the flower's stem in his fingers "The Horde had plans to eliminate you, but instead you went to the Beast Island. You were presumed dead for all these years, not even the Queen knew where to look for you."

"I lost everything that was important to me… That island…" he closed his fist "It makes you part of it when you give up. I needed to keep fighting."

Hordak was silent for a while, then King Micah commented:

"Your friend was also there a long time. She stole my food."

“Entrapta…” he squeezed the flower, breaking it into petals. “I never wanted she to go there. I thought she had betrayed me and joined the Princesses."

King Micah took a step back. He could be wrong, but it seemed to him that Hordak had some kind of affection for the woman. He approached slowly:

“I don't think you care about us or Bright Moon or She-ra, so why are you doing this? For Entrapta?"

Hordak felt his features flush, grow hotter. It was a strange feeling he only felt when he thought of her, something he couldn't explain:

"For science." He replied "She wanted to make this portal and I can help her, just as she already helped me." He put his hand on his neck, that small purple device belonging to the First Ones she put on when she moved his armor "She is different from the other Princesses, it's not a repugnant and primitive being, its genius is impressive."

“In other words, you like her." Micah arched his brow, flashed a slightly mischievous smile.

"Don't compare my admiration with these human feelings!" he said a little annoyed.

The king held back his laughter. Never in his life had he expected to see Hordak like this. He didn't trust him, but he knew his feelings were true, as he tried his best to deny them as his face grew redder and redder.

“Let's go back to the lab. The Princesses talked and made up.” King Micah said, so he turned his back "By the way, you can take one of these flowers to her if you want, girls usually like that."

He headed towards the exit with a slight smile on his face. He returned to where all the others were, already in position.

"Where's Hordak?" Entrapta asked

It didn't take long to come, he brought with him several flowers of different colors and species to deliver to Entrapta.

"What is it?" she asked, not understanding anything.

“I… thought it would be interesting to study what Shadow Weaver has done in this place." he said, holding out the bouquet.

“That's very kind." she held it with her hair "They are very beautiful, I will ask Perfuma for help, thank you very much."

Hordak looked at King Micah, who winked at him. He didn't quite get it, since that was the Wrong Hordak's mania, not his, but he wouldn't pay attention.

Entrapta lowered her visor, everyone was in position, a little calmer. Catra and Bow took a step back, just watching. King Micah drew a circle in the air, then the Princesses connected, glowing with their corresponding colors. Adora, like She-ra, Raised the sword. The stone on its handle resonated with something else, and as the portal opened, she felt something on the other side beckoning hee, calling her name. Finally, like a great circle of light, the portal was open.

Everyone watched, curious. Glimmer wanted to go past it and go after her mother, but before doing anything, a figure came out of him: he was a blond, strong and muscular man, wearing a white blouse, a pink vest and lilac pants, he was wearing a greenish tiger with him, he had a sword similar to Adora's.

"Who are you?" She-ra asked "What are you doing here?"

At first, he looked at her without saying anything, then he cracked a smile:

“My name is Adam, I am the Prince of Eternia. I came to find you, my sister."

She was paralyzed, too much to assimilate at the same time, although she knew of his existence, everything was too fast:

"Eternia... Prince... Brother..." she repeated aloud, trying to absorb it all.

“The Sorceress told me about you. At first I didn't believe it either, but..." he opened his arms "I'm here."

The princesses looked from one to the other, then she went back to being just Adora and hugged him, with tears in her eyes:

"I'm Adora..." She said with difficulty.

He was surprised by the sudden change, but he quickly understood, squeezing it tight:

"I think we have more in common than I thought..."

Bow, Scorpia and Perfuma melted by the scene, but Glimmer was worried, staring at the portal. She didn't want to interrupt the reunion, but he wasn't the one she'd expected to see first. She put her hands to her chest, apprehensive.

When the siblings parted, Adam went to Glimmer, bowed in awe:

“I take it you are the current Bright Moon Queen. It bears a lot of resemblance to Queen Angela."

"Do you know my mother?" she asked excitedly. "Where is she? Did she come with you?"

“She's in the Royal Palace with my parents, King Randor and Queen Marlenna."

Adora was listening intently, it was the first time she'd heard the name of her birth parents, she had so many questions to ask that she didn't even know where to start.

"Adam!" The tiger spoke "Isn't it better to do as the Sorceress asked?"

Everyone jumped back:

"Does your tiger speak?" asked Adora, startled.

“Oh, I almost forgot." The blond laughed. "This is Cringer, my best friend."

“This family likes cats." Bow joked

He heard Catra growl in protest, but said nothing.

“I have a horse named Swift Wind." Adora smiled "We have a special connection."

"Guys, this is amazing!" Entrapta cheered "we really managed to connect with other worlds! Any idea of the possibilities? So many questions!"

“I'd love to stay and meet you guys,” Adam said, “but I came to get my sister." He turned to her "The moment has come that everyone has been waiting for all these years!"

"Get me?" she took a step back "like… Now?"

“The Sorceress told me that long ago I had a twin sister who was taken from me, no one on Eternia knew of her existence except for our parents, the Sorceress and Man-At-Arms. At first I didn't believe it, she showed me images from the past, said that our twin swords had a strong bond and that I would recognize her the moment I saw her."

"Adam..."

“I thought it was impossible to recognize someone I'd never seen in my life, but your transformation into She-ra left me in no doubt that it was you."

"But there have been so many other She-ras..."

“None like you, my sister."

"And who said she's going with you?" Catra took a step forward "her place is here!"

“I also learned from Queen Angela about the evil they faced, the terrible Horde."

“You're late. "Hordak said disdainfully, crossing his arms "the Horde Prime has been defeated, my clone and I were the last ones left."

Wrong Hordak nodded, smiling.

“There is still a base on Eternia." said Adam. "Snake Mountain is under the control of the Skeletor".

Hordak's eyes widened, surprised to hear that name.

"By your expression, I think you know him." commented Catra

“He was one of my subordinates, but that was a long time ago."

“Queen Angela wants to help us stop him, so she stayed at the castle."

"My mother..." said Glimmer, "she's still fighting the Horde... even after all..."

“It was with her arrival that we learned of She-ra's existence and Sorceress had to tell us what happened."

"But it's been a long time since she disappeared, since the portal incident..." said Glimmer.

Catra lowered her head, hating to remember that.

“Man-at-Arms, our scientist, and Sorceress, with her powers, picked up the presence of a space-time anomaly, we found her

trapped between dimensions and cared for her until she recovered and could understand who she was and where she came from." he looked in King Micah's direction "and without wanting to be rude, I think she said the King was long gone."

"Long story. No one knew I was alive," Micah replied.

"And what's the plan now?" asked Bow

"I don't think the portal can stay open forever." Said Entrapta "if Adora passes to the other side, we won't have the 'key' anymore, only if they open it there."

"If you go through this portal, I'm going with you!" Catra took her hand.

"Me too!" said Glimmer. "It's my mother there!"

"Adam…" Cringer called, scared "do you think it would be good to go with so many people?"

"We need help and they want to go." said the blonde

"My daughter, I cannot lose you!" said the King

"Dad..."

"Actually," Entrapta began, "We can try to open the portal with help from both sides." she went to the computer "You said there's a scientist and a witch on the other side, right?"

"The Sorcerer and the Man-At-Arms."

"If we set the exact time, they can use their abilities there and we use ours here, my technology combined with King Micah's powers used at the same time might be enough to open the portal. When you leave, mark on the floor the exact place where the portal appeared in your world, that's how you'll know where to open it."

"Are you sure?" asked Adora

“If the Queen Glimmer goes to the other side, we won't be able to combine the power of the runestones anymore, because we need them all."

"In that case, she'd better stay." Said King Micah

"I'm not staying, I've already made up my mind."

"Glimmer!" said Bow

"You have to understand! And Bright Moon

will not be without a ruler, my father is here!"

He held her hand:

“Then I will too." Said the boy "Best Friends Forever style!"

"Adam..." Cringer whimpered.

"You do not have to be afraid." The blonde kept the smile "It's their choice."

"But will you trust people you've just met?"

“If they're Adora's friends, yes."

The tiger took a deep breath, there was no point in arguing.

"So are we going yet?" Adora asked

"I think you'd better pack your bags first." Adam said “And I want to warn my parents, they're going to be worried.

“The portal will close soon." said Entrapta.

"Speed is my specialty!" Glimmer would teleport and come back with suitcases "Bow, your parents will be rooting for you."

"Is this serious?" he asked. "You fixed it really fast."

"Maybe I already had some bags packed, in case of a rescue mission, even my mother..." She said a little awkwardly, gesturing with her hands, pressing her index fingers together.

“Then we're ready." smiled Adora

Before they entered, Scorpia hugged them, lifting them off the ground:

"Be careful! We want you to come back in one piece!"

"We'll still be here, rooting for you!" smiled Perfuma

"Punch that Skeletor guy in the face!" said Frosta excitedly.

Mermista was looking at them, worried about what they might face:

“Don't even think about disappearing." She said to Catra "I hope you come back alive to make up for what you did, as you promised."

The cat smiled mockingly:

“You know from experience that they won't beat me so easily. I will come back."

The blue haired girl turned away, still nervous.

“I will continue working here to ensure your safety." said Entrapta

"I'm going too!" Swift Wind appeared "If it's a mission for She-ra, you'll need me!"

“You don't know how dangerous the Skeletor can be." said Hordak. "You wouldn't be so excited."

"I know him." said Adam, "but I appreciate your concern."

"Have a good trip!" Wrong Hordak waved as they finally passed through the portal. Next stop: the Royal Palace in Eternia.

Reunions

Adam, along with Cringer, guided Adora, Bow, Catra, Glimmer, and Swift Wind through the interdimensional portal, finally arriving on Eternia. As soon as the blonde arrived in your home, the Royal Palace, a small creature with a wizard's hat, blue hands and ears, a cloak with the letter "O" stamped on it and a veil on his face leaving only his eyes showing, flew towards them, animated:

"Adam! You came back! I was very worried!"

“Good to see you, Orko." The blonde smiled "I want to introduce you to some people..."

"That's your sister?" he flew around Adora "It's a great pleasure to meet you, princess!"

"What you are?" she asked curiously.

“I came from Trolla, but a cosmic storm brought me to the Tar Marsh on Eternia." He said

"It seems to be common to receive visitors from other dimensions." Bow joked

"Yes, here in Eternia everyone is welcome! Queen Marlenna herself is not from here, she was an astronaut from a place called 'Earth'."

"What?" Adora was getting more and more confused.

“Take it easy, Orko." Adam laughed. "I haven't explained everything to her yet."

“So she doesn't know you are… you know."

“I'll tell her privately when we find the Sorceress. But she's like me, I'm sure she'll understand."

"What are you talking about?" asked Swift Wind "This is all very suspicious."

"I liked that horse." said Orko flying close to him "I feel a kind of magical aura in him, similar to the Battle Cat."

Cringer trembled just hearing that name.

"You talk a lot in riddles." Catra crossed her arms "Let's go right behind that Skeletor to go home."

"And my mother?" asked Glittering.

"Orko, can you guide them to the throne room?" I'll take Adora to the Sorceress."

"Of course, Adam." He flew excitedly "Just follow me."

Adora and Catra exchanged glances, confident they wouldn't be apart for too long. While her friends went with the little troll, Adam went with his sister and Cringer to Castle Grayskull, the drawbridge lowered, allowing them to pass to the throne where the Sorceress awaited them. She was a half-bird woman, with white, blue and orange feathered wings. She was sitting, got up and smiled when she saw them together:

"So you are Princess Adora." She had a soft voice "I am the Sorceress, I'm glad to meet you."

"I... I still don't know how to feel..." Adora said

"We've been looking for you for a long time, my dear. I couldn't say anything to Adam or anyone else until I was sure you were still alive."

"And... And what am I supposed to do?" she was scared

"Skeletor is getting closer and closer to seizing the secret power that lies in Castle Grayskull. Their swords were forged so that we could fight this evil, and today they finally come together again."

"The Sword of the First Ones..." Adora lowered her head. "I destroyed it to stop the Heart of Etheria..."

“But I saw you transformed into She-ra." said Adam

“I imagine you've honed your skills over the years." Sorceress smiled "She-ra's powers along with He-man's will be unbeatable."

"He-man?" Adora raised an eyebrow, frowned, intrigued.

"I was about to show you." Adam took his sword and raised it "By the power of Grayskull!" a powerful light enveloped him "I have the power!"

The boy's skin was more tanned, he looked stronger. He pointed at the Cringer and made him the Battle Cat, bigger, braver and with his red armor. Adora was really surprised, this explained a lot:

"That's why you said you were like me... incredible!"

“King Randor and Queen Marlenna don't know. “The only ones who know your secret are Man-At-Arms, Orko and me." The Sorceress said

"My friends know I'm She-ra, I mean, it's not like I wear a mask or anything..."

"The truth will be revealed in due time." said Sorceress. "You were separated as babies, during an attack by the Horde. Skeletor ended up staying behind when Hordak abandoned him on Eternia, so he made Snake Mountain his base of evil. Alongside him work Evil-lyn, Mer-man, Beastman, Tri-klops, Trap Jaw, Spikor, Clawful and other loyal minions who faithfully follow his orders."

“Hordak is not what he used to be." Adora commented "He had a little change after meeting with the Horde Prime... I wouldn't say he became a good person, but the Fright Zone will gradually cease to be one of his bases."

“Skeletor might want to find him." Sorceress said "they have more history together, but this is not the time to talk about it. I bet you really want to meet your parents, don't you?"

"I don't know what they'll think about me..."

He-man reverted to his common Adam form:

"You're their daughter, they'll be really happy."

She smiled, they headed back to the Royal Palace, they would meet up with the others.

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Meanwhile, Orko was leading the small group to the Throne Room. Glimmer had the scepter in her hand, gripped it tightly. Bow put a hand on her shoulder, could feel her tension from afar. He smiled at her, and even without a word, they communicated. She nodded, she was glad her mother was alive, she finally had both her parents back.

They stopped at the signal of Orko, who was bowing to the throne:

"King Randor! Queen Marlena! I bring you friends from afar!"

Everyone bowed in respect, even Catra.

“It's an honor to be here, Your Highness." said Glimmer

“I imagine you are the daughter of Queen Angela. said the King. "I see a great resemblance. I asked Teela, the captain of the Kingsguard, to bring her here safely."

"Adora wasn't with you?" asked the Queen

"Adam is with her!" Orko hastened to answer "He was really excited to meet his sister!"

"I understand." Said the king "I also asked them to call my father, King Miros. I bet he really want to meet his granddaughter"

It didn't take long before they heard footsteps, Teela was accompanied by Man-At-Arms and right behind them was Queen Angela. Time seemed to stop, Glimmer couldn't help but see her mother's face once more, dropped her staff, jumped up to hug her as she burst into tears:

"Mom... I'm sorry for disobeying... for going with Shadow Weaver... I'm so sorry..."

Angela sketched a simple smile, her eyes teary, hugged her tight:

“You did what you thought was right, my dear."

There was so much they wanted to say, but they ran out of words. She wanted to stay in her arms forever, go home and get on with life, but she knew they couldn't. Bow held himself not to cry too, watching the reunion of mother and daughter.

Teela managed a smile, though her eyes were melancholy. Man-At-Arms held her hand, he could understand what was going on in her mind, and there was still more to come.

When Adam finally arrived at the palace in the company of Adora, there was barely time to say anything, the King and Queen rose from the throne and ran towards their daughter who had been missing for so long. Adora felt her heart lighter, although she had just met those people, she could feel a huge affection coming from them, a love different from what she had already experienced, the meaning of maternal, paternal and fraternal feelings. Adam was part of the hug, a family finally reunited.

Bow wept with emotion, but Catra was thoughtful. It didn't take a word to understand that Adora was loved in this place. She looked away, her mind was confused, she wanted to be happy for her, but thoughts of Shadow Weaver invaded her mind. She knew she wasn't her mother and she hadn't even treated her well all hee life, but she was the closest thing to a family she'd ever known.

Teela looked at Man-At-Arms, her adoptive father. She truly loved him, but doubts about her mother resurfaced. Perhaps with the arrival of these people, her identity might finally be revealed, but it was not the time to bring it up.

"There's so much to talk about..." Queen Marlenna was holding Adora's face, looking into her eyes. "It must have been so hard..."

"I wouldn't even know where to start..." replied the blonde.

"I think we should organize a party!" suggested Orko "I have some perfect tricks for the occasion!"

"Orko!" Man-At-Arms warned "The guests have just arrived and you already want to expel them?"

"I liked the idea." Adam said "For today, you are all our guests."

“The entire kingdom should know about Princess Adora's return. It's not something that happens all the time,” Teela said.

"I don't know if it's necessary…" the blonde began.

"Hey! Party!" Swift Wind stirred "a great reception!"

“That horse is an interesting animal." commented Man-At-Arms

“We can say that he's like Cringer." Adam winked at him "Only more partying."

"I like parties." Said the tiger "Mainly food."

Everyone laughed. Everyone seemed very excited about the idea, except for Catra. She wanted to believe that she wouldn't lose her, but it was still very difficult to put everything that had happened behind her. Perhaps they would never return to Etheria.

They were guided to their quarters, Glimmer would share a room with her mother, was so agitated to talk that she would not be able to sleep, sat up in bed:

"So much has happened since you disappeared... So much..."

“Gkimmer, I'm so glad to see you. "she smiled, still lying down" but I worry that you has left Bright Moon..."

"Our kingdom is not unprotected, in fact, it's the first thing I wanted to tell you! Daddy is alive!"

Angela almost jumped when she heard this:

"What did you say?"

“Dad, King Micah! He's been on Beasts Island for years and now he's been rescued! Well, the Horde tamed its power for a while, but we've brought it back! The Rebellion has finally defeated the Horde! Bright Moon, or rather, all of Etheria is safe now!"

The Queen took a while to absorb it all, but she was really relieved to hear that.

“You really have become an excellent Queen." she said. "I'm proud of you, my daughter."

"But Bright Moon still needs you, mother... I made so many wrong decisions too... There are so many commitments... I understand why you didn't leave the kingdom..."

“You're doing your best. I wasn't the best of queens either, I hesitated to fight for a long time..."

“Mom…” Glimmer hugged her, “you were the best Queen. I hope to be as good as you one day."

She hugged her back:

“You will be better than me."

They talked a lot until they fell asleep.

In the other room, Adora was still awake, perhaps the fear of falling asleep and when waking up nothing would be real. She felt

very good around those people, she reflected on everything they had told her, the international travels, a place called Earth, the swords they both carried... Would it be a destiny to fulfill again? Would she have no choice but to fight again? She sighed, almost laughing. Queen Angela was in battle all this time, who knows, by defeating the Skeletor's empire, they could finally have some peace. Shee turned her face away, she needed some sleep.

Snake Mountain

In a place far away from where the heroes were, someone was watching them, curious.

“Looks like we have visitors at the Royal Palace." Skeletor laughed devilishly, as he sat on his throne

"Who are they?" Evil-lyn asked. "They don't seem to be from Eternia."

"You're wrong, dear witch. “I seem to have a score to settle with an old friend after all.”

"What do you mean?" Beastman asked, confused.

"Is one of them your friend?" Trap Jaw scratched his head.

“No, idiots!" Skeletor stood up "They are the key to him. The girl is Prince Adam's twin sister, if we catch her, he'll have to call He-man to save her."

"Haven't we tried a plan like this several times already?" Evil-lyn asked “We've already caught the Prince's stupid cat and each of his friends, none of this ever worked out. Why do you think his sister would be any different?"

“She still doesn't know the terror of facing me. We'll make her regret returning to Eternia! Nyehehehe!"

The next morning, everyone was invited to have their breakfast in the royal dining room, where there was a huge table with a delicate white tablecloth, served with an assortment of breads and cakes.

King Randor and Queen Marlenna sat at the end of the table, next to them were Prince Adam, his sister Princess Adora and Catra. On the other side sat Teela, captain of the royal guard, Man-At-Arms and Bow. At the other end of the table were Queen Angela

and Glimmer. Swift Wind and Cringer were elsewhere, despite the horse's protests about wanting to sit at the table.

“Tell us more about Etheria these days." The king said “Queen Angela told us about the Rebellion and about the constant attacks of the Horde. We'd like to know how things are there now."

"The Horde Prime attacked us, threatened to destroy everything..." Glimmer began.

"Is that this Hordak?" asked Man-At-Arms

"No." She shook her head "Hordak was nothing but one of the clones of the original Horde Prime. After the rebellion won, he ended up staying at Bright Moon's Royal Palace."

"What did you say?" Queen Angela rose "Did they leave Hordak in Bright Moon? Why didn't you tell me that part?"

“Don't worry, Your Majesty!" Bow hastened to answer "He's with Entrapta, you'd be surprised how harmless he is."

“You believe too easily in the goodness of others." muttered Catra

“I've always believed in yours." Adora smiled at her.

The cat turned her face, lowering her ears. She really wanted to be worthy of that trust, but she knew that not everyone was like the blonde.

Adam watching his sister's behavior with her friend, arched an eyebrow. He could be wrong, but there seemed to be something more between them. Before commenting anything, he missed something. Looked around:

"Where's Orko? He's not usually late for coffee."

“I hope it's not in my lab." commented Man-At-Arms

“He talked about a surprise." said Teela, "soon he appears."

Indeed, the little creature was in his room looking for something:

"Man-At-Arms was right, I should pack my things..." he flew away, scratching his head and rummaging through his piles of mess "Oh, I found it!" He took a magic wand "I bet Adam's sister and her friends will enjoy some tricks."

He was calmly flying down the hall when he heard footsteps:

"Huh? Have they finished your breakfast without me?" He went in the direction of the sound, but ended up surprised by Skeletor's men:

"It's that arach magician!" Tri-klops pointed

"Hold him so he doesn't warn the others!" said Beast Man

"I'd rather go!" said Oeko, then disappeared from their sight, reappearing at the table where the others were:

"Orko!" said Adam. "You took your time!"

"I was almost getting used to the quiet." joked Man-At-Arms

"There is no time!" He said nervously "They're here!"

"Who's here?" asked Bow, confused.

"Tri-klops and Beast Man!"

"Impossible!" Teela rose "How did they get through security?"

"I don't know, I just know I saw them!"

"Teela, prepare the defenses." King Randor got up "We don't know if it's just them."

"We can help?" asked Bow

"Thanks, but it could be dangerous." The king replied

“I can fight!" Adora got up "I'm..."

Before finishing the sentence, Adam covered her mouth with his hands:

“Sister, I'll take you to a safe place, don't worry."

She didn't get it right, she just followed Adam

"I will go too!" Cringer ran, scared

“Tell us how to help." said Glimmer

Teela was in charge of strategy, meanwhile Adam and Adora went to a room away from the rest.

"What are you doing?" the blonde asked nervously.

“I told you before, no one knows my identity." Adam said "I needed to move away in order to transform. For your sake, I think it's best to keep it a secret too."

"So that's why you dragged me here?"

"Yeah." He looked to the sides, took his sword and raised it "By the powers of Grayskull!" incredible rays enveloped him as he transformed "I have the Power!"

He pointed the sword at Cringer, who became Battle Cat.

Adora knew what to do, the sword appeared in her hands:

"For the honor of Grayskull!" She increased in size, her hair became long and golden.

They left the room and went straight to the throne room, they needed to ensure that the King and Queen would be safe.

In fact, those weren't the only Skeletor's henchmen who had invaded. Evil-lyn surrendered the monarchs with her magical powers, was surprised by the arrival of the heroes:

"He-man! Appeared earlier than expected!" She looked at the girl "And who is she?"

"I'm She-ra!" she replied, taking a step forward "Leave them alone!"

Evil-lyn threw her magic at her, but it was countered by the sword.

"That power..."

"I don't know what Skeletor wants this time, but it was very daring to break into the Royal Palace like that!" He-man pointed his sword at her "they should have learned their lesson by now."

"Evil-lyn!" Trap Jaw appeared screaming through the halls "They're stronger!"

Soon he was hit by an arrow that became a net, trapping him. Glimmer teleported to the throne room with Tri-klops tied up:

“One minus now."

Catra easily yielded Clawful with her whip:

“Scorpia's are far more powerful." She made fun of him

Orko managed to confuse Trap Jaw with his magic, causing his weapon to fire a "Bang" sign.

Teela fought Beastman, froze him with her ice ray:

“I think it was the last one." she said as she entered the room, she was surprised to see He-man accompanied "Who is she?"

“My sister, She-ra." He Said “If I were you, I'd go back to Snake Mountain.”

"I'll do it." Evil-lyn smiled. "I guess it wasn't all useless after all."

She used her magic to disappear and took the rest of her colleagues.

“We are very grateful to you!" said King Randor. "I did not know that the hero of Eternia also had a sister."

“The Sorceress helped me find her, Your Majesty. Together we can finally put an end to Skeletor's evil plans."

"I hope so." said the King. "Have you seen my son Adam? I hope he hasn't been captured..."

"He is fine. He managed to get his sister away in time,” She-ra said.

“He can be brave sometimes."Teela joked

Bow and Glimmer looked at each other, not quite understanding what they were talking about. It was obvious to them that He-man could only be that prince, if he had just said that She-ra was his sister and, as far as they knew, Adora had no other brothers.

“I think we better go." Said He-man "But we'll be around if another attack happens."

They ran back to the room so they could return to their normal form. Adam was used to acting that way, but for Adora it was all very confusing, since there was no secret on Etheria.

"Mom! Dad! are you ok?"

"Yes, Adam." Queen Marlena said “I'm glad to see you thought quickly of Adora's safety.”

She smiled, not knowing what to say, she exchanged glances with her friends, she would explain later.

"So these were Skeletor's terrible henchmen?" asked Catra, bored. "They're just a joke. Defeating this asshole will be a breeze."

“I wouldn't be so sure." said Man-At-Arms. "He doesn't tend to act so obviously. You would be surprised at the creativity of his plans."

"Do you think it would be better to investigate, Daddy?" asked Teela.

"Yes, but let's save it for later. Everyone must be tired after this victory."

“And I haven't even had breakfast yet." commented Orko

Everyone laughed, they would return to the dining room.

****

Evil-lyn returned to Snake Mountain:

“Skeletor, I hope you've watched this carefully."

“Don't worry about that." He laughed "The plan turned out better than I imagined."

"But we couldn't get Princess Adora!" said Trap Jaw

“I didn't expect them to succeed, but I had a chance to watch my new enemies in action. The pink-haired girl can use magic, the boy has a bow and arrow, the flea cat can fight, but the best is what we found."

"You mean this She-ra?" asked Evil-lyn

“Just as Prince Adam has a sister, so does He-man. Let's get ready to storm Castle Grayskull."

“You can only be crazy." said Beast Man. "We've just been defeated, how do you think we're going to invade?"

“Idiots, we won't have to do anything."

"What's on your mind, Skeletor?" Evil-lyn asked

“If I'm right, I can take revenge on everyone on Eternia and also on my former master, Hordak, who abandoned me on this planet."

"How will you do this?" asked Mer-man

“All in good time, fish face." Skeletor said

Everyone looked at each other, not knowing what was going on in his perverse mind. The battle was just beginning.

Castle Grayskull

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adam showed his sister some of his princely routine, the diplomatic meetings he attended with his parents, and the battle training with Teela in the royal courtyard. She was more skilled than he was with her sword and shield.

"Adam, focus!" Teela scolded "we already practiced this exercise before."

"I can try?" asked Adora

“Let's see what you know, princess." Teela handed her the weapons.

“No need to take it easy." the blonde smiled

Teela advanced with her sword, Adora defended with her shield, then retaliated:

"Impressive." smiled the captain of the guard "Where did you learn to fight?"

"In the Horde." She replied so naturally that she didn't even notice.

Teela was surprised to hear that, she ended up dropping her sword:

"The Evil Horde?"

Man-At-Arms, who was sitting watching everything, got up and went to her:

"Are you okay?"

“I knew you had been taken, but how long did you live there? What happened to you?"

"It's a long story..." Adora sighed." I didn't find out the truth until I found...” her gaze was fixed on Adam, she'd have to omit a few things “well, when I found Bow and Glimmer. They showed me that I was being lied to. That's how I joined the rebellion."

“You really had a hard life." said Teela. "Someone of your knowledge would be very useful in the royal guard."

“I don't know if the King would approve of that." Man-At-Arms said "Put his own daughter to fight."

"But what about me?" Adam arched an eyebrow.

"Cut it out!" Teela laughed "It's important that you know how to fight and defend, but I would never go to the front lines in a gwar. That's what the Royal Guard is for."

“I can't just watch." said Adora. “On Etheria, all princesses fight. I don't intend to hide."

"I Liked you." Teela said “Adam could learn a few things, since he always disappears when danger arises.”

“That's enough, Teela." Man-At-Arms said "I think you can take a break from training today."

“As you wish, Dad."

She went back inside the castle, Adora was staring at them:

"Don't you mind if she talks to you like that?"

“I don't blame her." Adam shrugged "She doesn't know I'm He-man."

"But why not?"

“No one can know my identity, it's the only way to keep Grayskull's secrets safe."

“By the way,” Man-At-Arms said, “The Skeletor's attack earlier struck me as odd."

“Today we had help from our new friends." Adam smiled "I bet the skull guy didn't expect this."

“Or was studying us." Man-At-Arms continued.

“That Skeletor looks like a lot of work." said Adora

"I think it would be good to visit the Sorceress to see if she knows anything." said Adam

“I found you!" Catra appeared "Have you finished training?"

“We were about to leave." Adora replied, then turned to Adam. "Can she come with us?"

“I don't know if it's a good idea." replied Man-At-Arms

"But she knows who I am!" replied the blonde "It was thanks to her that I saved Etheria!"

"What are you talking about?" asked Catra "where you will go?"

“If you're my sister's friend, you're my friend. said Adam. "I'm just going to get Cringer." entered the Palace

"I think it would be good to take Swift Wind." smiled Adora

"What do you mean?" Catra was getting impatient.

“We think today's attack may have some greater purpose." Adora replied

"Adora!" Glimmer and Bow came with Swift Wind "Were you going to leave without us?"

"I don't know if I can take them all..." she said, a little awkwardly.

"But we always act together!" replied Bow. "Best friends forever!"

"Don't tell me you're going to do things just with your brother now." said Glimmer, a little jealous.

Adam returned with Cringer:

“I'm of the opinion that the more help, the better."

"Excellent." muttered Catra "the squad of idiots assembled again."

"Your friend has a strong temper." commented Adam

“She grew up with me in the Horde, another long story." Adora said

“I think they'll need ships." said Man-At-Arms "I don't think your pets can handle carrying so many passengers."

"Do I really need to go?" asked Cringer, startled.

"What do you need that fearful cat for?" asked Catra

"He's my best friend, I've taken care of him since he was a kitten. Even if it doesn't look like it, he is very useful to me."

“You can tell the story on the way." Man-At-Arms called them to the ship

Adora, Glimmer, Bow, Catra, Adam, Cringer, and Swift Wind went to the ship. Next stop: Castle Grayskull.

As everyone present knew the truth about She-ra, Adam continued the story about how he turned his frightened cat into the mighty Battle Cat, although the first time he shot out of the Sword by accident. Adora told him that with Swift Wind was similar, she had taken a liking to an ordinary horse and by accident turned him into a unicorn pegasus with the shine of the sword.

“You two are really siblings." Bow smiled

They laughed together, until they reached their destination and disembarked.

“I'll stay and watch the ship. Keep me posted,” Man-At-Arms said.

The drawbridge lowered, allowing them in.

"So this is Grayskull?" Bow looked around excitedly "My parents would love to study this!"

The Sorceress was sitting on her throne when she saw them enter:

“Welcome, people of Etheria. It's an honor for me to have you here. I am the Sorceress."

"We are grateful for the reception." smiled Bow amicably.

"Cut the small talk and say what matters right away." Catra was saying a little impatiently, although she was just a little nervous about the place. She had already heard 'for the honor of grayskull' more times than she liked, just imagining the kind of power that would be stored in that place already gave her goosebumps.

"Skeletor sent his lackeys to the castle this morning." Adam said "they were quickly beaten, but Man-At-Arms fears it was too easy.".

"I understand." said the Sorceress "he must know about the arrival of the Princess Adora."

"Was it a plan to take her?" asked Bow

"More than that." the Sorceress rose "Skeletor knows who took her years ago. May be seeking revenge greater than meets the eye."

"What does that mean?" asked Glimmer

"I will tell you a little more about his relationship with Hordak." she said

Everyone paid attention to the story:

"Many years ago, before the Skeletor was who he is, he used his power and influence to try to take over the kingdom. King Randor himself faced him personally with his sword, but the enemy was powerful and played dirty. In a cowardly attack, he threw a bottle of acid at the king, but when defending himself with the shield, caused the acid to return to the face of the one who threw it, this almost killed him. Evil-lyn took him to the holy altar, and there he begged Hordak's help to keep him alive at any cost. At this moment, Hordak attended to him, but in exchange for his life, the man lost his face, leaving only his skeleton. whatever humanity or goodness he might have had in his heart was lost that day."

There was silence when she finished counting. Cringer trembled, crouched down with his paws covering his face:

"That was scary..."

"You never told me that." Adam said

"And that's what we're going to have to deal with?" asked Adora

“With the combined powers of He-man and She-ra, we will put an end to this story. Eternia and Etheria are siblings planets, they have very powerful magic. King Grayskull was a great hero who fought against the forces of evil, in the great battle against King Hiss and the Snake Men he ended up losing his sword. Hordak who defeated them, but then attacked Eternia. King Grayskull went to the Oracle of Selecia, deep in the forest of Selecia City, where even the power of his wife, Queen Veena, sorceress at the time, did not reach. The Oracle instructed him on a journey, passing through the Corridors of Lithos until reaching the Valley of Dragons, surviving there, he arrived at the Labyrinth of Thorns, where many never returned. After that, he passed through the Sands of Time, heading to Mount Imperium. At the peak of the

mountain, he found a cave where the Oracle himself awaited him with his sword, the same one he had lost in the battle against King Hiss. King Grayskull fought Hordak and won, but ended up badly wounded. With his last strength, he transferred the power to the Sword, so by becoming He-man, in fact, Adam is acquiring the power of the ancient King Grayskull, great hero of Eternia. His wife swore to protect the sword and the castle, and even when he left, a successor would take his place until such time as evil would strike and a new hero would rise. I carry on the legacy since I left my old name behind, so I can never leave here. The Sword of Power and the Sword of Protection contain what is needed to protect this stronghold from the forces of evil."

"Hordak really is even worse than we thought..." whispered Glimmer.

"Funny that now he's there in Bright Moon in good spirits." Swift Wing commented aloud.

Everyone turned towards the horse:

"What did you say?" asked the Sorceress.

"He's under surveillance." Said Glimmer "We don't trust him, but he's the one who helped us make the portal so I could find my mother..."

"People change." Adora said while holding Catra's hand.

"I believe Skeletor has business to attend to with his old 'friend'." said Adam.

"We'll need you here more than ever." The Sorceress nodded "This could be our last battle."

Catra swallowed, squeezing Adora's hand. She didn't want the fate of the world to be on her back again. They exchanged glances, the blonde overflowed with confidence, she would fight for the place where she was born, for her parents and for her brother.

Chapter End Notes

Skeletor story from the 2002 He-man cartoon

Skeletor's plan

Skeletor plotted his latest plan. A few years ago, when King Hiss tried to rule Eternia, Hordak had decided to collect his debt, but Skeletor chose to destroy the temple from which he would be summoned. He never knew that Evil-lyn had also tried behind his back, but now, knowing Hordak was free on Etheria, he could plan his next steps. He had become much more powerful than he had been in the past, and once he had the power of Castle Grayskull, he would rule all of Eternia.

He gathered his army, they would march towards the Castle, forcing He-man and the other Masters of the Universe to unite in battle. Beastman would summon the worst land and flying creatures he could imagine, the marine creatures would be Mer-man's responsibility. Tri-klops was building an army of war robots next to Trap Jaw, Evil-lyn had a magical gem that amplified her powers.

Skeletor was ready for the counterattack, with an ancient spell, he wouldn't even have to fight He-man, let his own sister do it.

Meanwhile, at the Royal Palace, Teela commanded the troops. Adam had returned with Adora and her friends, Queen Angela was with the captain of the guard analyzing the maps of the region and studying where a possible attack would come from.

"Skeletor uses his tricks to get to the palace." Teela said “But his main objective has always been Castle Grayskull."

"The Sorceress has always protected it with He-man's help," said Man-At-Arms "but she fears that this is at last the final battle."

"What do we do?" asked Orko

“We have reason to think the Skeletor wants to try to confront Hordak." Adora said “He may have seen it when we passed through our interdimensional portal."

“That first attack of his was really weird." Adam commented. "When it comes to Skeletor, you should expect the unexpected."

They went back to analyzing the maps.

Stratos flew over doing their patrol along with the Buzz-off and they noticed the advances of a very diverse army, they could recognize which part was guided by Beast Man and which was being controlled by Tri-klops.

“You notify the king and queen." Said Stratos. "I'll go after the others."

Buzz-off nodded, headed to the palace with the news everyone had been waiting for:

“Skeleton is on his way to Grayskull."

Queen Angela and Queen Marlenna looked at each other, then turned to the king, who rose from his throne:

“Let's go."

Teela was at the head of the guard, soon they met up with Stratos who brought Ram Man, Man-E-Faces, Fisto, Mekaneck, Sy-Klone and Roboto into battle.

“We're going too. " Glimmer took a step forward.

"My daughter..." Angela said.

“I'm stronger than last time. Let us help."

Bow also took a step forward, but before Adora could follow him, Adam tugged on her arm:

“I think we should stay at the Palace in case something happens."

"He is right." said Man-At-Arms "We must not risk the lives of the prince and princess."

It was really weird for Adora to have to "hide" for others to fight. Catra looked at the blonde crookedly, but didn't say anything.

"We'll be fine, I promise!" Adam smiled, then took her to a secluded room. Cringer accompanied them

“Do we need to fight?" the tiger trembled

“If all goes well, it could be our last fight." Adam said

He took a deep breath, then waited.

"By the powers of Grayskull! I have the power!"

He became He-man, the most powerful man in the universe, then made Cringer transform into the mighty Battle Cat.

"For the honor of Grayskull!" Adora turned into She-ra and they finally joined the others.

“I thought you were going to hide." Catra provoked

The blonde managed a smile, she had promised her brother that she would keep her family a secret.

They marched towards Castle Grayskull.

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Sorceress was in position, watching everything from the window. She had put a force field around it to withstand some attacks. Both armies arrived, Grayskull was the center of the war. Skeletor and King Randor took a short break before starting:

"So you came in person, dear Randor?" laughed the villain "Today Eternia will fall!"

“You won't escape this time, Skeletor." Said the King "Your legacy of evil ends here and now!"

“I expected you to say that." he replied, then raised his magic staff, giving the command to the army "Attack!"

“Forward, men!" The King ordered raising his sword.

The ships advanced at Teela's command, firing at Tri-klops' robots. Bow assisted in the ranged combat against some Beast Man creatures, he knew that if he knocked him out, they would be free. Evil-lyn had a clash with Glimmer, magic against magic. He-man advanced with Battle Cat straight to Skeletor:

"You don't lose by waiting, Nyehehehe"

“Looks like you're the one who's always been waiting for this." The blonde laughed, stepping forward.

She-ra and Catra fought side by side against some of the other henchmen:

“Very exciting family reunion." chuckled Catra as she scratched at some Trap Jaws' minions.

The blonde smiled. Even in the midst of a war, she was not shaken. They've won once, knew they could win again.

Skeletor continued his fight against He-man, but he had instructed the Evil-lyn about his plan. She was using her power against Glimmer, who used teleportation to confuse and attack her:

“It's impressive for a little princess." Evil-lyn laughed

"I am a queen!" She appeared in front of her shooting with her father's staff.

The villain defended herself, so she created an illusion where she made it look like there were several of them on the field. Glimmer went out punching one by one, and with that the real one left the scene unnoticed. It was in the direction of She-ra, who was busy with some robots, Evil-lyn laughed and fired a spell in her direction:

"Adora!" Catra shouted

She turned, turned her sword into a shield to protect herself, little knowing that was her opponent's goal.

Her magic was created based on the artifact's virus, corrupting the power of her sword's runestone, her eyes changed from blue to red, her expression was filled with rage:

"Adora? " Catra called, confused, then turned towards Evil-lyn "What did you do to her?"

Before she could respond, the wildcat had jumped on her, and she barely had time to defend herself. She took some scratches, but she wasn't angry, on the contrary, she had received a very interesting information:

"Skeletor will love this!"

She quickly disappeared. She-ra, now corrupted, attacked without seeing if it was ally or enemy, Catra ran looking for Glimmer to tell what happened. The Princess was getting exhausted fighting the Evil-lyn copies, still to no avail.

"Glimmer!" Catra shouted "She's not there!"

"You look nervous, what's wrong?"

"That witch did something to Adora! You need to use your powers to undo!"

"What?"

The war continued with no end in sight, attacks from both sides, it was not possible to say who had the advantage.

"She's out of her mind!" Catra took Glimmer's arm "I need your help!"

She had never seen Catra so desperate as now, no matter how tired she was, she needed to go to Adora's help:

"Where is she?"

Before she could answer, the blonde appeared with her evil red eyes, attacking them.

"Oh no..."

Meanwhile, Evil-lyn went to where Skeletor and He-man were fighting, both with their swords.

"Skeletor!" she called to him, smiling. “It's done."

He couldn't contain the satisfaction of hearing that the most important part of his plan was complete.

"What is done?" asked He-man, confused. "What are you up to?"

“Turn around and see for yourself." He pointed, laughing.

The blonde didn't understand well, as he saw She-ra attacking her own friends in the middle of the war:

"What is happening?"

“The stone in your sister's sword has a weakness." Skeletor laughed "With this virus, she corrupts and loses control!"

"You monster!" exclaimed He-man angrily.

“And it gets better." Evil-lyn said “The big-mouthed cat called her name. Looks like your secret identity isn't so secret anymore, isn't it, Prince Adam?"

Skeletor was perplexed to hear those words, he turned to her:

"What are you saying, Evil-lyn?"

"Exactly what you heard!" She said triumphantly. "I saw that girl call She-ra 'Adora!' And if she really is He-man's sister, it can only mean he's Prince Adam!"

The man was unresponsive, with his secret out and his sister out of control, the only idea that came to him was to ask the Sorceress for help telepathically. She was focused on trying to maintain the force field around Castle Grayskull, but she heard the pleas of her hero who was now filled with doubts as he had to face his own sister:

"You are not alone." she told him telepathically. "Look around, those who fight for you. If it's your destiny to let them know the truth, now is the time. Ascend, Prince Adam, champion of Eternia!"

That made him feel better, he would buy time fighting with She-ra, he turned to Catra

“Ask Teela for help. I can try to hold my sister, but I need the Captain of the Guard to stop Skeletor!"

'We'll go to her!' Glimmer nodded, took Catra's arm, and teleported away.

The redhead was commanding the troops against Tri-klops' robots when the two girls appeared:

"Captain Teela!" said Glimmer. "He-man needs your help right now!"

"I can't leave my post, can't you ask someone else?"

“He said it has to be you." said Catra "I already commanded an army in the Horde, I can take your place!"

"You can not be serious..."

“There's no time, Teela!" said Glimmer.

She was thoughtful, it was a complicated situation, but she didn't know if she could leave it in Catra's hands, as she barely knew her and the idea of her having worked for the Horde still made everything more difficult.

“Call my father." she said. "I'll leave you in charge if my father helps you."

"You think I can't do it?' Catra frowned, clenching her fist.

“Adam trusts you because you're friends with his sister, but I've seen your behavior with others. If you want to prove yourself, it will be on my terms."

She wanted to retort, say she didn't obey orders, but she would be wasting valuable time that should have been used to help Adora. She took a deep breath, trying to calm down.

"I do. Where is he?"

“With your friend Bow trying to capture Beastman. “If he's taken down, there'll be one less army to worry about.”

"I Understood." Glimmer teleported close to Beastman's creatures, it didn't take long to bump into Bow:

"Glimmer? Why are you here?" He asked

She was exhausted, breathing heavily, as soon as she recovered a little, she explained:

“Skeletor got Adora, right now she's fighting He-man. He asked me to seek help from Teela, but she cannot leave the post of commander."

"Then she asked to call me." Man-At-Arms commented, who was nearby and heard everything "We're close to capturing Beastman in an ambush we created."

“I can take care of it from here." said Bow "He's almost in our trap. Adora's safety needs to be a priority."

"You really are a good boy, your parents must be very proud of you." Man-At-Arms said

He smiled, he couldn't wait to tell them about everything that had lived on Eternia. He would save those thoughts for later.

“Then I will take you to Teela." said Glimmer, holding out his hand, but she looked tired.

“We can go in one of the airships, you're already using too much of your powers." Man-At-Arms commented

“If you do, Beast Man will see us." Bow said "You need to rest."

“I'm a long way from Bright Moon, the power of the crystal is what stabilizes my magic. Even if I rest, it won't make much difference." Glimmer replied

"But you shouldn't risk your teleportation like that!" said Bow worried.

"What other alternative do we have?' she asked

"Can I help?" Orko appeared, flying over the place

"I'm not sure." Man-At-Arms said “You know your magic doesn't work as it should."

"I know I'm clumsy, but I want to help!" He held out his arm to Glimmer. "My tricks don't work outside of Trolla, but I have a lot of magic. If I lend it to you, you can use it as you see fit."

"Isn't that dangerous?" asked Bow

"He-man needs help." the little one replied "I just want to be useful. Everyone is doing their best, I know I can do it!"

They looked at each other, but they knew there was no time to waste.

"Here we go." Glimmer shook Orko's hand, then took Man-at-Arms's arm, transporting him to where Teela was with Catra

“You took your time." the cat complained

"Technical problems." chuckled Glimmer. "I wouldn't have made it without help."

Orko had used up most of his magic, but there was still one more trip left.

“I need you to take over with Catra, Dad." said Teela.

"Excellent." He said “We're counting on you, my daughter.

She hugged him, then turned to Glimmer

"Are you sure you can handle this?"

She took Orko's hand:

"Absolutely."

Teela, Glimmer, and Orko disappeared before Catra

“Save Adora, please…” she whispered.

The Prince struggled with some difficulty, as he didn't want to hurt her, but the artifact's virus made her attack mercilessly, not to mention that he had to deal with Skeletor and Evil-lyn who were heading to the gates of Castle Grayskull.

Revelations

Teela came along with her friends to help He-man. Watching him fight his own sister was really sad, but there was no time for sentimentality. She took her sword and shield to attack Skeletor directly, wouldn't let him lower the door of Castle Grayskull.

"Do you think you can really stop me?" he laughed

"Do not underestimate me." she said in combat position "I didn't become the Captain of the Guard for nothing!"

Evil-lyn threw a spell at her, but it was repelled by her shield. Being close to the castle for some reason was giving her more strength, as if she could feel the power welling up inside her.

"What does that mean?" Skeletor was surprised, as he had seen her in action several times, but never like that "Evil-lyn, defeat her!"

"As you wish, Skeletor!" she said lifting her staff and firing some of her power.

Teela couldn't explain how or why, but she could fight Evil-lyn a's attacks back at her.

"This is impossible!"

Sorceress watched from the window, smiling. She always knew she was powerful enough to defend the Castle, she was very proud of the great woman Teela had become.

Meanwhile, Catra and Man-At-Arms continued to guide the troops against Tri-klops and Trap Jaw's machines, devised an air attack plan, guiding Stratos and Buzz-off to capture them. It was hard to escape Tri-klops' sight, but with the army of beemen buzzing and flying around him, they got the moment of distraction needed for Buzz-off to arrest him.

Stratos and his birdmen were in charge of Trap Jaw, under Catra's orders he managed to find a loophole in his attack to take him out of command of the machines.

“You really know how to lead an army." Man-At-Arms said

“Teela's instructions on each were really accurate." She replied “With a combined air strike, they wouldn't be able to escape."

“You have your merits."he said

“Not everyone thinks so." She said without looking at him "On Etheria most princesses still hate me. It wouldn't surprise me if Queen Angela hated me too, since it's my fault she ended up in this dimension."

“I'll be honest with you. The conditions of the trip may not have been the best, but I appreciate that she came here. We would never know the whereabouts of Princess Adora if it weren't for that."

Catra lowered her ears thoughtfully.

"We need to help you. Now that we've captured whoever ran the machines, let's go after She-ra!"

“We need to stop the Beast Man's army of beasts as well." Duncan warned "Bow and I devised a way to capture him, your help would be very useful to us."

She was a little surprised to hear that. She was looking in the direction where Adora was, then turned to him:

“Let's get on with it."

Beastman rode on the back of a flying, fire-breathing dragon, Bow expected him to pass an exact spot where his arrows would fire with nets. It was never his intention to harm any of the animals, for as Duncan had explained to him, they are all docile creatures if they can free them from their leader's mind control. Stopping the

dragon wouldn't be easy, it only took a few seconds for the shots to happen, but Bow was surprised by Man-E-Faces with his monster face:

"Calm down, big guy!" Bow said taking a step back.

He didn't seem to be in his right mind, in fact, when he was monster-faced, he was vulnerable to Beastman's mind control.

"Help...Me..." he pleaded as he advanced on the attack.

Bow didn't want to hurt him, even more knowing it wasn't his will. He looked up, the dragon was almost where he wanted to be, he couldn't let himself be distracted:

“You have to fight this! We're on the same side!"

Man-E-Faces was trying, but it seemed in vain, that's when suddenly someone came running and headbutted him:

“Calm down." said Ram Man

"Right in time!" exclaimed Bow, "but how did you know..."

“Man-at-Arms and that friend of yours gave me instructions to cover for you." He smiled "Our friend here will be fine, you can finish the job."

The boy nodded, and just as planned, threw his capture nets at the Beast Man:

"But what is this?" he muttered, surprised.

The nets shocked him into unconsciousness, definitively releasing his animals and also Man-E-Faces, who was a little stunned:

"What... What happened?"

“Welcome back, friend." Ram Man extended his hand "We now have instructions for defeating Trap Jaw." He turned to Bow "Do you think you can tame these beasts?"

"Do not worry about this." He smiled "Swift Wind will come to my aid, you can go."

They nodded, then left him alone. He whistled a few times, waiting for the horse to come, as agreed, but something was wrong. As soon as he appeared, he had red eyes, possessed by the same virus that attacked She-ra's sword:

"Swift Wind?"

He was furious, out of control. Bow took a deep breath, placing the arrow in his bow:

“I just went through this. I really don't like the idea of shooting allies, so please forgive me."

There was nothing to hurt, if he could immobilize it would already be a victory, what worried him was thinking that Adora was probably in the same situation.

In fact, she continued to attack He-man without recognizing that it was her own brother:

“You need to fight this, Adora!" he said while defending himself with the sword "Remember who you are!"

"It's useless!" Skeletor laughed "This spell was made especially for her sword stone, nothing can undo it!"

Teela continued to fight Evil-lyn, although part of the attention was on He-man:

“You are monsters! Cowards!" Said taking down Evil-lyn "Put two siblings to fight like that!"

“Don't be upset." the witch laughed "blood ties mean nothing in a war, the important thing is to win!" she attacked, but the redhead retaliated

"Family goes far beyond mere blood ties!" replied Teela.

“Try as much as you like." said Skeletor. "Your tongue is sharper than your sword, but it won't affect me. I will take the power of Grayskull for myself and force the Sorceress to open the portal to Etheria, where I will take revenge on my former master, Hordak."

Glimmer and Orko were sitting close to the place, too exhausted to help. She raised her head upon hearing the name of her former enemy:

"We can't let this happen..." She wanted to get up, but Orko stopped her.

“He-man will make it, he always does."

"But She-ra..."

“It's not the first time a mind-bending spell has fallen on us, I've fought my Uncle Montork twice over it myself."

"Your uncle..."

“He's from Trolla, he's the one who taught me everything I know about magic, even if it doesn't work well here on Eternia." He looked straight ahead "But the most valuable lesson he taught me is that no magic beats love. He-man and She-ra will get through this, I trust them. And I will try to help when my magic is recovered."

Glimmer nodded. Catra and Man-At-Arms had taken down much of the army, and with Teela's power, they would have time to recover and return to battle.

Sorceress was able to continue to maintain her force field around Castle Grayskull while Teela defended it with her bare hands. She couldn't understand why she felt so much power emanating within her, but with Evil-lyn's attacks there was no time to think about it.

“Looks like it's not just Prince Adam who has his secrets." said the witch

"What you mean?" Teela asked. "Adam is in the Royal Palace!"

“Don't be fooled, warrior. He's on the battlefield right now, fighting his own sister!"

The redhead didn't understand at the time what that meant, but Skeletor decided to expose the facts:

“Your dear hero, He-man." He said laughing "He's Prince Adam. Don't tell me the Kingsguard Captain didn't know."

It was like opening her eyes, if it were true, it would explain Adam's childish behavior and why he always disappeared at the most important moments. She've also never seen both side by side. It was as if the pieces of a complicated puzzle had finally fallen into place:

"Why didn't he tell me?"

That moment of distraction was enough for Evil-lyn to land one of her shots on the redhead, who was surprised by the discovery.

"Finally!" exclaimed Skeletor. "Now the castle is at my mercy!"

Sorceress focused her magic on something that would restore the girl's strength. There was no more reason to hide hee identity, she telepathically communicated with her:

"Teela! Can you hear me?"

"What? At where?"

She was a little stunned by the blow she'd taken, now surrendered to Evil-lyn's power, trying to find the strength to get up.

“He tells the truth,” the Sorceress continued. “Prince Adam was chosen to inherit He-man's power, just as Adora inherited She-ra's. His secret was kept so that Eternia would be protected."

"I still feel confused..."

“There's one more thing you need to know: It's your destiny to become the new sorceress."

"What? But why me?"

“The answer that has long been denied you, the truth that dwells in your heart that your father could not say."

"The truth..." Teela was thoughtful, "my mother..."

“I ask you to forgive me for everything you've been through in the last few years. I've always wanted to tell you, but with the responsibility of protecting Castle Grayskull, I've never been able to leave here, save in the form of the eagle Zoar."

As she lay on the ground, listening to the Sorceress's words, she felt something strange inside, the presence of her mother. She'd felt it once before, when she'd almost fallen from the endless chasm that surrounds Castle Grayskull. It was as if, at the same time that she was surprised, she felt in her heart that she had always known, as if it were a truth lying dormant in her mind that was now surfacing along with the revelation that Adam was He-man.

Everything was clear in her mind, the great affection she had for both of them, she remembered when he himself had asked which she preferred, and she herself knew she couldn't choose. "Someone with the intelligence of Adam and the courage of He-man", was what she replied to him, was what she had in mind and admired in each one. Thinking of them as the same person made her rethink her attitudes towards the Prince. How many times did he not want to tell her and couldn't?

Everything was clear now. Hee mind and heart that yearned for answers had found her mother and the identity of Eternia's hero. With her mind free of doubt, the power of Castle Grayskull filled her, accepting her as the Sorceress's successor. Evil-lyn noticed her spell being broken as the redhead got to her feet:

"Haven't you given up yet?" she asked a little annoyed.

"I will never give up." She dropped to her knees and then stood up "I am Teela, Captain of the Kingsguard! The next Sorceress of Castle Grayskull!

She had a glowing aura around her, Evil-lyn shot at her once more, but her power was countered:

"What just happened?" she said in surprise, taking a step back.

"You're going to take away the spell you cast on She-ra!"

"I want to see if you can make me!"

The two began to fight, Teela had her sword and Evil-lyn had her staff, the warrior against the witch.

"It's kind of a shame." Said the redhead *We've worked together before, I know that if you were by our side you could do great things with your power."

"I do what I want." Evil-lyn replied "I will take Grayskull for myself, so I won't follow anyone's orders anymore!"

"I won't allow you to take another step!"

Teela was advancing on her, but the adversary used her power to create an illusion where there seemed to be several. The redhead closed her eyes, she could feel which magic was coming from, she attacked the real one directly:

"How did you know?"

"Your tricks don't work on me, Evil-lyn!"

They followed their combat full of physical and psychic abilities.

The Bastard Son of King Miros

Chapter Notes

> For this chapter I wanted to bring some of the history of the Skeleton from the comic "origins of the Skeletor". I didn't find it to read, I wrote it based on the summaries I read.

Skeletor would try to approach the Castle while the two fought each other, but another figure appeared to stop it:

“You won't take another step."

He was King Randor, dressed in armor and holding his sword.

"Well well. So the King himself came to fight me. I would worry more about your children if I were you."

"My children?"

Skeletor didn't do much ceremony, he pointed to He-man and She-ra who were fighting each other intensely.

"But they..."

"Prince Adam and Princess Adora! He said "I'm surprised even you didn't know that. He hid secrets from his own family!"

"What did you do?" the king asked angrily.

"Why don't you go over there and help them, Randor?" Skeletor laughed “Or are you used to the idea of two brothers trying to kill each other?”

"What are you implying, Skeletor?" He arched an eyebrow.

"You know what I'm talking about. Look at my face, Randor! Everything that happens today is your fault!"

"You are crazy!"

“Ask the former King Miros, your father. Or rather, our father."

“I thought you no longer accepted your identity as Keldor." The king said

“Keldor is long dead, dear Randor, but nothing changes the fact that the crown should have been mine! I am the rightful King of Eternia!"

"No one will accept you as king!" Randor replied "Not after all you've done!"

"What if I tell your kids? What will they think?" He laughed. "Actually, that's exactly what I'm going to do."

Skeletor mounted Panthor, his panther, and set off to where the two siblings were at war, turning his back on Castle Grayskull. Teela and Evil-lyn ceased combat upon seeing him pass:

"What happened?"

King Randor followed him on horseback, causing the two of them to follow as well.

Catra and Man-At-Arms had arrived where Bow was, after the capture of Beastman he had to deal with Swift Wind possessed by evil powers, knocked him down with his stun arrows.

“We need to help Adora" said Catra, sounding almost like an order.

"I can't leave Swift Wind in this state."

“Others can do that." She Said "Adora needs us and her 'best friends forever' bullshit."

The boy smiled:

"I never thought you'd say that!"

“Just don't make me repeat it."

Man-At-Arms called Stratus to assist the winged horse, so they climbed into his ship to fly to where she was. They landed near Orko and Glimmer:

"What are you doing standing there?" asked Catra

"I need to rest. I won't be useful in this state," she replied.

"He-man is still fighting." said Orko "but he hesitates to attack with all his might."

"We have to try to hold Adora down." suggested Catra. "Then make the witch undo it."

"Maybe we can buy time if we take her sword away." said Bow

"Wait!" exclaimed Man-At-Arms "Skeletor is coming and King Randor is right behind him!"

"We won't let him interfere!" said Catra

They were at their posts, ready to defend He-man in case the villain decided to strike him.

"Stop where you are!" Glimmer raised her staff.

"Don't worry, princess." Skeletor chuckled, then made Panthor stop. "I just came to tell you a story."

"What kind of trick is this?" asked Man-At-Arms

"Skeletor!" Evil-lyn called "Why didn't you attack Castle Grayskull?"

"I'm glad you're all here. My army fights its pathetic masters of the universe so I can take back what is rightfully mine!"

Duncan looked at the king, somewhat confused:

"What is he talking about, Your Majesty?"

“It's about my brother, Keldor." replied the king

"Brother?" Hearing this disturbed He-man's concentration, giving the opportunity for She-ra's attack, but Teela came forward with her shield, defending him:

“I told you, Adam." she laughed "never let your guard down against an opponent."

"Teela?" He said surprised "So you know..."

"News spreads fast." She replied. “We'll talk about it later, first we need her to calm down."

Skeletor cast a spell to freeze everyone for a few minutes:

“I don't like to be interrupted." he said, that wouldn't hold them much, even more with the magic of Orko, Glimmer and the Sorceress field "Listen to the only and legitimate King of Eternia!"

"Have you decided to assume your true identity?" asked Evil-lyn

"Exactly." He said "I am the eldest son of King Miros, but being of the Gar people, he did not consider me legitimate for the throne. One of Hordak's men tried to take Randor away when we were children and I saved him. I would have killed him if my "dear" little brother hadn't stopped me. When we grew up, our father preferred Randor to me to take his throne, I would be a mere adviser in the King's court. It was after that stupid decision that I made a pact with Hordak to take back what was mine! My face was totally destroyed by this cause! I wandered lost through a cursed desert, I saw death face to face while I felt my face melt! I returned to the palace through a portal, and my stupid brother still wanted to forgive me, but as I had promised Hordak, I stabbed him in the back, for I needed the King's blood to achieve my goals. That's how I joined the Horde, became Hordak's favorite apprentice, until the day I returned to Eternia. Our plans to kidnap the next heirs failed and only Princess Adora was taken, that traitor left me behind! Now more than anything I demand my

revenge and you who came from Etheria are the key to getting it!"

“You will never reach Etheria!" said Glimmer. "We won't allow it!"

The spell that made them paralyzed ceased, but Skeletor was not frustrated, on the contrary, he was laughing like he had never laughed before:

"Fools! She-ra is the key I needed! The only one with power equivalent to He-man and the secret to finding Etheria! Ever since Queen Angela set foot here I've watched her waiting for that day! Before long I will have taken Castle Grayskull and all its power! Hordak will feel my revenge!"

He-man heard everything while still defending himself from his sister's attacks, but he was getting exhausted. Looking at his weapon, it was not only the Sword of Power left by King Grayskull, but it also had the power of the Sword of the Patriarchs, which had long been hidden in Snake Mountain. He had the power to win, but he had never in his life used that power to hurt anyone, only in his own defense. She-ra was good not only with the Sword of Protection, but also with her abilities to transform it into other weapons. He looked around, not wanting to depend on Teela to protect him, even more so now that she knew his secret.

He glared at his sister, her eyes red. That wasn't her, he needed to bring her back. His friends were busy with Evil-lyn and Skeletor, he would have to think of a solution on his own.

"Adora..." he said his name aloud "I hope you'll forgive me..."

He went up with more force, attacking with his sword. He didn't really want to hit her, but if he could get the sword out of her hand, he'd hold it with his own arms.

Evil-lyn attacked, but Teela defended, could hit anything. She was really agile, she ran around the witch to confuse her, Glimmer felt better, she could at least use teleportation to buy time.

King Randor lunged at Skeletor with his sword:

"If you think it's my fault, then it's my duty to get it over with!"

“Blame our father for giving the crown to someone as helpless as you, Randor!"

"I had to take the throne when he disappeared! It took Man-At-Arms and I years to find him in the Swamp of Enchantments, ruled by Enchantress! And where were you?"

“Don't be sentimental." Skeleton attacked "I trained in the Horde for years!"

“I really care about the people of Eternia!" he defended himself with his sword "A crown means nothing if your king is not brave to protect his kingdom!"

"All will obey me, for better or for worse!"

It was a terrible battle, where there seemed to be no winner.

"What will we do?" asked Bow

“I don't know about you,” said Catra, “but I'm going to free Adora."

She understood better than anyone what it was like to be controlled and fight against one's own will, the Horde Prine had implanted a chip in her once, and the feeling was terrible. She didn't need to do much, she sneaked up to grab the blonde from behind:

"Hey, Adora!" She held her tightly "This is for your own good!"

It was the opportunity for He-man to snatch the sword from her hands. The red stain that was the hallmark of the artifact's virus was spreading. She-ra had reverted to her Adora form, but totally dizzy and bewildered, almost as if she was drunk.

"Hey, Catra!" She said smiling, beside herself "It reminds of old times."

"Get out of here, Adora!" Said Catra as she held her in her arms.

“You look angry but you're happy to see me." she laughed

She didn't answer, she agreed that that state was better than if she was aggressive, but it still wasn't what she wanted.

Evil-lyn saw that She-ra's sword was lying on the ground, but Teela wouldn't let her approach:

"Your fight is with me!"

He-man still didn't know what to do, as he had never seen anything like this before.

"He-man!" Sorceress called him telepathically "Break the spell so she remembers who she is!"

"But how?" he looked around, his father was fighting Skeletor, Man-At-Arms, Glimmer and Bow came to the aid of Catra and Adora. That's when his eyes met Orko's:

"That's it!" he said. "We will use magic against magic! Orko, I need you to use your spell to counter Evil-lyn's!"

"Me?" he asked surprised "Do you want me to do that?"

"I need you! It's the only way to free my sister once and for all!'

“But what if I fail? My magic is messed up..."

“And you've saved our lives several times with it. I trust you, you need to trust yourself!"

The little one flew towards the Sword of Adora, which was on the ground:

"I can feel enormous dark power emanating from this weapon..."

He swallowed hard, fate was in his hands, everyone was counting on him and it made him nervous. How many times have he tried a few tricks and failed? How many times have he heard a Man-At-Arms lecture for not being able to control his powers? He took a deep breath, this was not the time for this. He began to remember Dree Elle, his great love who was in Trolla awaiting his return. He had promised to return when Skeletor was defeated, so he couldn't hesitate now. Concentrating, he spread his hands over the sword:

"I order, with the power bestowed upon me, that wherever it is, the crystal be destroyed! Virus leave this sword and may Princess Adora be cured!"

His magic enveloped the sword with a strong glow, the red spots began to disappear and the blonde regained consciousness. She raised her hand to her head:

"What..."

"Adora!" Catra hugged her "finally!"

"Catra..." she sighed "sorry for the worry I caused..." She looked at her brother, who was now smiling relieved "I apologize for everything I've done."

“The important thing is that you're safe." he replied. "Thank the Orko for that."

"Pathetic!" exclaimed Evil-lyn as she saw her spell undone by the little trollan. "It's too late now, our armies have advanced far enough"

“I wouldn't be sure about that." Man-At-Arms replied “Most of your commanders have been captured, now would be the time for you to step back."

Skeletor, who was still fighting Randor, jumped back:

"I'm close enough to Grayskull. He said “I've lost my stupid lackeys, but the Sorceress is exhausted. Even with Princess Adora by your side, all I need is her Sword! "He reached out, with his magic brought the weapon close "This is the key that brought Queen Angela here, and with that same power I will give Hordak what he deserves!"

He raised her sword, focusing his magic to summon a dimensional portal similar to the one Hordak had opened years ago.

Portal Between Worlds

There was no time to prevent the portal from being opened, a huge light appeared right there, in the center of the war, and at the same time on Etheria, where signs quickly picked up by Entrapta:

"Something's happening in the Fright Zone!" She said showing Hordak her device "The signs are similar to the portal. Do you think they're coming back?"

He took the object in his hands to analyze it better, his expression always serious:

“Notify King Micah as soon as possible. The unusual way it came about can be a problem." He handed the device back to her "I'll go there."

"I'll go with you!"

"No. I refuse to let anything bad happen to you." He turned his back "And it will be more useful if you can alert the king and the other princesses."

"Hordak..."

She understood the importance of the mission that had been given to her, she asked the guard who watched him to let him go.

“I have very clear orders not to let you out." The gusrd said

“But it's an emergency!" said Entrapta. "All of Etheria can depend on it!"

"Leave it to me." A second guard appeared "I'll take your shift. Orders of the Bright Moon King."

"As you wish." the first guard greeted her and left.

"We don't have time for this!" said Hordak in frustration.

“That's why I came to help." The guard blinked in a peculiar way "I never get tired of it."

"Double Trouble?" Entrapta smiled "I didn't know you were still in Bright Moon!"

“I never left, honey. I take it as a compliment because it means my acting is convincing."

“I must leave immediately!" Hordak said

"I wish you good luck." Entrapta smiled, then went to opposite sides of the hall, she went to the throne room while Hordak and Double Trouble took a ship and set off in the direction of the detected anomaly.

***

Meanwhile, Skeletor was bragging about his great achievement. Even with their army slowly falling, the Masters of the Universe no longer had as much strength to face their next attack. He was close to Castle Grayskull, one step away from achieving the power he had always craved. The portal opened in front of him, somewhat unsteadily:

“You will be the first to behold the utter destruction of Etheria and the rise of Eternia's new king!"

Catra was trembling, it brought back bad memories. Adora noticed, put her hand on her shoulder.

“Don't worry, I'm here with you."

She didn't necessarily need the Sword to transform, her thoughts about the safety of her friends and feelings about Catra were enough to awaken the power that had once saved Etheria.

"For the honor of Grayskull!" She said advancing towards Skeletor, who was caught off guard by the attack.

Evil-lyn thought about interfering, but Teela stopped her attack:

“Your fight is with me, remember?"

"You're already getting on my nerves!"

He-man went after Skeletor, would help his sister retrieve the sword, worry about the portal later.

Hordak was on his way to the other side, he had a theory about what was going on.

Through that light he could see the other side, his former pupil Skeletor who was battling the two twin siblings heirs to the throne. He needed to close the portal to prevent the destruction of the place. He brought with him some tools and devices to measure energy. Entrapta's help might be useful, but he didn't want to risk it. Never wished any harm on Etheria, in fact. What he wanted was to dominate the planet, to have all the territory for himself as supreme ruler, and all to prove his worth to the Horde Prime, but now none of that mattered to him. He knew that the atrocities he had committed would never be forgiven by the people of Etheria and the kidnapping of Adora was a very serious attempt on the planet Eternia. As much as Entrapta had helped him, not only in his work but in accepting his imperfections, he knew it was impossible to remain by his side. He took a deep breath, then called out:

"Skeletor! I heard your call!"

Eternia's warriors ceased their attack, the skull face turned around at his name, he recognized that voice:

“Hordak, my former master." He began to laugh "So we finally meet again!"

"Hordak!" Catra exclaimed, surprised "What are you doing here?"

“I came to finish what I started." he replied. "I knew this anomaly could only be Skeletor's doing!"

“I think you have a lot to talk about." He-man commented.

“It's not the time!" said Man-At-Arms. "This portal must be contained!"

“Queen Glimmer!" called Hordak. "I need you to use your magic!"

"Don't think you'll seal my portal so easily!" exclaimed Skeletor

"I need my sword back!" She-ra advanced, gripping the hilt as she tried to take the weapon out of his hands.

"Do not even think about it!" He tugged hard "You could end up destroying everything! You don't know what you're dealing with!"

"You who do not know!" She continued to tug "It can destroy our reality if not careful!"

"Glimmer!" Hordak called from the other side "teleport here! Your magic is strongest near Bright Moon!"

“But what exactly are you going to do?" she was confused

“If we don't close, the same reality distortion as last time could happen."

She looked at the tug of war between She-ra and Skeletor, Teela's fight with Evil-lyn, the others in battle with an army that kept on coming.

"Bow!" she called. "You need to bring my mother here!"

"What?"

“She will go through this portal and find my father. I won't close it before then!"

"We do not have time!" said Hordak. "King Micah has been warned, his troops will defend the realm!"

“She's with Queen Marlenna." said He-man. "Battle Cat will take you there with speed."

The Princess smiled:

"Thanks."

Bow mounted the giant tiger and set off to summon the queen. He understood how his friend felt, because it was through a portal that she lost her mother the first time.

"Fools!" laughed Skeletor "You don't have the capacity to beat me now. My troops will pass to invade Etheria!"

“I wouldn't count on it." said Hordak.

“You're the one who told me I should claim my throne, remember? I stabbed my brother Randor at your command! Everything that happens today is because of this moment! The rise of the great Skeletor King, formerly known as Keldor!"

"You are crazy." He-man held the Sword's hilt as well, making a dispute between the three of them "I can't believe that all this time you were my missing uncle!"

"Blame your father, He-man! Or rather, Prince Adam!"

Bow returned in a ship with the Battle Cat and Queen Angela, who was piloting it was Queen Marlenna herself in her astronaut costume:

“This is where you get off." She said “I'm going to help my husband rescue some wounded."

"Thank you for the ride." Angela held Bow so they flew to the ground as the Rainbow Explorer ship circled around.

"Mom!" Glimmer ran over to her, hugging her.

"My dear..." she stroked her hair "Bow summed up everything for me on the way here, I'll cross the portal with you."

"No you won't!" Evil-lyn tried to advance towards them.

"Stay cool!" Teela fired her icy beam, paralyzing her, finally.

"Stop wasting time!" called Hordak "we need to close this as soon as possible!"

Glimmer used her power to reach the other side along with her mother, who was still confused about Hordak's intentions.

"The others are on their way!" He said "Entrapta has summoned them by now."

Angela and Glimmer joined hands, using the power emanating from Bright Moon to contain a possible explosion.

As expected, Entrapta summoned the other princesses to combine the power of the runestones, Mermista, Scorpia, Frosta and Perfuma came to concentrate their power. She-ra finally got her sword back:

"Surrender, Skeletor!" she said. "You don't have control anymore!"

"This portal will change everything!" he laughed uncontrollably "I'm going to rewrite history where I am the supreme God of the Universe! You may have taken the sword back, but you don't know how to use it!"

"You must come this way!" said Entrapta. "The passage between the worlds will be sealed!"

"Wait!" said Catra "What do you mean?" She looked at Adora "won't we be able to come back later?"

"I'm not sure..." said Entrapta, "opening portals is very dangerous, though scientifically exciting."

"Are you saying I have to choose now?" She-ra asked "It's going too fast, I didn't think about it!"

"If Adora stays here, I'll stay with her!" said Catra

The princesses' power was shown to be swayed by the phrase, as Scorpia could hear it. She always knew that Adora was her choice, but she didn't think she'd see her leave without being able to say good-bye.

“This has to be done now!" said Hordak

Glimmer saw Bow on the other side, she should have carried him when she brought her mother, but it didn't occur to her at the time.

"You can cross without fear!" Sorceress' voice seemed to echo through the place, but in fact she was concentrating her telepathic power "This portal will close, but it's not goodbye!"

“You heard!" said Teela. "No time! Pass!"

Bow whistled, Swift Wind already felt better since Adora regained her sanity, Stratus had taken care of him in the meantime enough to be able to fly again. He appeared with the Bow's call:

"The party looks pretty lively." he said

"We have to go through the portal, it will soon be closed." Bow said

"When you say 'we'..." The Horse said

“I'm not going without Adora." said Catra

“So just the two of us now." replied Bow

"Isn't She-ra coming?" Swift Wind asked

"Time is running out!" exclaimed Hordak.

"Not now..." Bow sighed "But this is not a farewell, let's trust her."

The horse nodded, taking the boy on its back and crossing to the other side.

"Anything you do is useless!" mocked Skeletor. "I can't be defeated!" He pointing to He-man "You've had the opportunity to kill me several times, but your sense of justice and your pathetic heroism always prevented it. I doubt you'll do anything now that you know I'm your uncle."

He-man looked at him, at his sword, at his sister, at his father fighting in the war, at his mother helping soldiers. What was right? What decision should he make? He never really wanted to kill Skeletor, He couldn't live with the guilt, the weight of death.

"He-man!" Sorceress called to him in his mind "There is one thing you can do."

"What? What is the solution to this impasse? How to end this?"

“She-ra's Sword is not the only key. Together, you can close and ensure that nothing bad happens to both planets."

"But how?"

“Trust yourself, your sister She-ra, and my daughter, Teela.

"Teela..." he sighed aloud.

"What are you thinking, He-man?" The redhead caught his attention.

“Let's close the portal together with Skeletor forever." he replied raising his sword "by the powers of Grayskull!"

The blonde nodded, raised her sword too:

"For the honor of Grayskull!"

"What do you think they're going to do?" asked Skeletor.

"They do not." Hordak then walked through the portal, holding Skeletor from behind.

"What are you doing?" asked Entrapta

"Seal the portal while we're in the middle, it'll trap him in a dimension he'll never get out of!" Hordak said

"But and you?" Said Entrapta sadly "You go too!"

"And I'll be doing it of my own volition." He replied smiling at her.

Sorceress communicated with Teela, giving her instructions on how to release her magical powers through Castle Grayskull, she put her hands in front of her, made signs with her fingers, moved her arms masterfully, as if she had done it before. It was about following instructions, she was always good at that. When it was over, both swords threw the power to close the portal, with the help of the attunement of the princesses of Etheria, who glowed on the other side, the huge light disappeared along with the bodies of Hordak and Skeletor, now trapped in another unknown dimension and outside of reach.

She-ra and Catra had stayed on Eternia with no time to say goodbye to their friends, she reverted back to her normal Adora self, just as He-man reverted back to being Adam. Man-At-Arms helped enter the ship, would take them to Castle Grayskull next to Teela, King Randor took care of the last Skeleton soldiers who were now surrendering for losing their leader

Conversations

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adam and Adora woke up in some room inside Castle Grayskull, they were lying on beds, a little disoriented.

"Hey, Adora!" Catra smiled when she saw the blonde open her eyes "It looks like you saved the universe again."

She sat down and then hugged her:

"I'm sorry for making you stay here..."

"Hey, relax. I chose not to go through the portal. This whole portal thing still gives me the creeps."

Adam was waking up too, saw that Teela was sitting next to him, arms crossed:

"At last." she said in a serious tone "we have to talk."

"Good morning to you too." He sat down, grinning.

"Why didn't you tell me? I thought you trusted me!"

"And I do. I always wanted to tell you that I was He-man, in every commitment I left, every fight I ran away from. Believe me, my life would have been easier if you could have known."

"Then why?" She had a sad face

"To protect Eternia and the secrets of Grayskull. The only people who knew were the Sorceress, Orko, and... Well, the Man-At-Arms."

"My own father lied to me all these years..." she stood up, her back to him, "not just about your secret, but about my mother..."

"So now you know…"

She turned around, surprised:

"Did you also know She was the Sorceress? What else have you been hiding?"

“I found out the day you went to visit the Oracle."

"But I never... Wait! What are you saying?"

“The Sorceress had to erase your memory. The responsibility for Castle Grayskull meant that she had to hand you over to the Man-At-Arms, there was no way she could raise you here. I know you can understand..."

"All these years..." she clenched her fist nervously "I never knew where I came from... And you kept everything from me..."

"Teela..." Adam began, but the words fled.

“Don't blame him." Duncan appeared. "If you want to take out your anger, do it on me."

"Daddy..." It was hard to describe what she felt at that moment. During the war she didn't have time to sort her thoughts, just accept information, but now it was different. “I don't know if I can trust you again."

“The king and queen didn't know anything either." said Man-At-Arms. "Adam wanted to tell, but the responsibility was too great." He put his hand on her shoulder "You are the Captain of the Guard, I know you understand what it means to have a duty to perform. Everything was for Eternia."

"A duty to perform..." she repeated with her head down.

“I did my best to be your father, my dear. You have grown into an extraordinary woman, and I am very proud of what you have become."

She lifted her face, looked him in the eyes, and then hugged him:

"I wouldn't choose anyone better to be my father."

He breathed a sigh of relief, then hugged her back.

After giving them time to recover, Sorceress called them to the central hall, where she waited on her throne:

“Champions of Eternia, I am very grateful for your help in defending the castle all these years."

Catra and Adora joined hands, intertwining their fingers.

“Skeletor is now trapped between dimensions." She continued "I do not guarantee that we will never see him again, for knowing his powers and wiles, perhaps one day return. But for now, we will live in an era of peace away from their constant invasion attempts."

Adam was smiling, for the first time in years he would have some rest like He-man and he could devote himself to his princely duties.

“While they slept, the kingdom was planning a huge party in celebration of the victory, where all the Masters of the Universe who helped us in this battle will be. Skeletor's minions are trapped in the palace dungeons, they'll spend a good few years without causing any problems."

"Party..." Adora lowered her head.

"Something wrong, princess?" asked Sorceress

"My friends... They left without my being able to say goodbye... They also contributed to this victory..."

"Oh yes. I can use my powers to create a safe portal so you can go from Eternia to Etheria whenever you want."

"Really?" She lifted her head, excited.

“I studied your dimension when they opened the portal to come and also when Skeletor took your sword. I can locate It so you won't have to choose one of two worlds."

The blonde barely knew what to say, hugged Catra:

"You heard? We can go and come back whenever we want!"

“Looks like I'll still be able to fix things in Salineas." she laughed

"Mermista! I had completely forgotten!" Adora said

Catra sighed, she could fix her mistakes after all. She hadn't expected that sacrifice coming from Hordak, now trapped in some other dimension alongside his former student.

Everyone went to the Royal Palace. When the siblings arrived, they were welcomed by King Randor with open arms:

"Good to see you well! Who would have thought that our hero was you! You fooled us very well."

"So you're not angry?" asked Adam

" I don't deny that it took me by surprise, but knowing all the deeds as He-man during all these years, I can't punish him, on the contrary, I thank him. I am very proud of what you did for us."

The prince could barely contain his emotion when he heard those words, after so long with the "lazy" and "irresponsible" Adam, he could finally hear his father say he was proud. The king then turned his attention to Adora:

“My daughter, long gone, returns a great heroine. I can't express what I'm feeling right now, I'm the happiest father in the universe!"

He hugged them once more, only letting go because his wife called him. The party was a great celebration of victory, tribute to all the warriors who gave their lives in defense of the kingdom and the return of Princess Adora who had been missing for years.

It was a very beautiful celebration, the people cheered their monarchs. Teela was still a little confused about how to feel, but she really couldn't deny that it was the prince's great deeds. It would take time to get used to the idea.

Catra was a little distant, it was strange to be in a lot of people with no apparent danger, Man-At-Arms went to her:

"Aren't you going to join us?" He asked

"The party is for heroes."

“And you've proved your worth to us." He smiled, extending his hand "The princess is lucky to have you by her side."

He left her alone to think, he wouldn't force anything if she didn't want to either.

Catra watched her beloved Adora be hailed once again as a hero alongside her brother, the joy of her parents. There was no doubt in her mind that this was her place, although the Sorceress told them they wouldn't have to choose between worlds.

"Folks!" Orko flew over the table with a glass in his hand, catching everyone's attention "I'm very grateful for all the years you've welcomed me here."

“You've helped us a lot." said Adam

"That's why I want to take advantage of this party to announce my engagement to Dree Elle!" He said “I promised her I'd return to Trolla as soon as we could get rid of Skeletor."

"So you're leaving?" Man-At-Arms said surprised.

“It's not goodbye. I come back to visit the palace whenever I can."

"I'll miss you..." said Cringer

The little one would fly to each of his companions to give them a hug. Close to Man-At-Arms' he was a little uncomfortable, but the man hugged him:

"Surely your antics will be missed, my friend."

"I thought you didn't like them..."

“Just because I yell at you doesn't mean I don't want you around. This kingdom will no longer have the same grace." he laughed

"I promise to visit you." He flew to Adora "It was a pleasure to meet you, princess. Send your regards to Glimmer for me."

"I will. In fact, I really need to get back to Etheria and see if everyone is okay."

“Relax a little, sweetheart." Queen Marlenna said "Enjoy the party, you also need to rest."

"All right mother." it was kind of weird to still have someone to call mom, but it was a great feeling "I'm going there early tomorrow morning, so my friends will know it's okay."

Catra heard from afar.

Tomorrow.

If she had something to say, she would wait until the next day. She tried to enjoy the party with the others, she feared it would be her last.

Chapter End Notes

I haven't watched the Netflix version of He-man yet, so this conversation is how I imagined Teela would react when she

found out the truth.

Back Home

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Dawn came, Catra opened her heterochromatic eyes slowly, the light coming from the window illuminating the room. She was still in Eternia, in the Royal Palace. There was a lot to think about in the last few days: she had led an army to help protect Grayskull. She was a born leader, after all. She got out of bed, stopping to think, she had no place to stay, regardless of whether she was on Eternia or Etheria, she didn't have a roof to call her own.

She heard someone knock on the door, it was Adora who radiated the place with a beautiful smile:

"I'm glad you're awake now!" she said. "Sorceress said we can go when you're ready."

Catra turned her face away, turned her back to her.

"Some problem?" The blonde approached slowly "We don't need to leave now if you don't want to..."

"You really want to see your friends, don't you?" she asked

"Well, they must be worried, since we don't have contact..."

"And what do you intend to do afterwards? Go back and forth?"

"I... I didn't think about the details. The Sorceress said she can always open the portal, I don't have to choose here or there"

There was no answer, Adora arched her brow:

"Are you upset with me? I did something?"

Catra sighed, then turned around.

"No. I'm happy for you, because everyone wants you around. There are many places to go and they will always welcome you with open arms." She lowered her head "As for me... If I'm not with you, I'm not worth anything, it's always been that way."

"Catra, that's not true! Shadow Weaver has gotten it into your head, but you're more than that! I wouldn't be here if it weren't for you!"

"Adora..."

“I'm really sorry for everything you've been through and all the times I couldn't be with you like I promised, but I want to be right now." She holds her hand "I love you, Catra. You've proven your worth, you're not a 'shadow' of mine or anything like that. I also want to be where you are, where you feel happy."

The cat didn't answer, she felt the soft touch of her beloved's hand, so she lifted her face, looking into her eyes:

“I love you, Adora. I've always loved."

She managed a smile, pressing hher lips to hers in a warm kiss. There was no one else who made her feel this way, complete. A lot had changed since they were simple children raised by the Horde, now, after all, they were finally together.

Headed to Castle Grayskull with the help of Man-at-Arms's flying ships, the portal was about to be opened:

"We will await your return." Queen Marlena hugged her daughter

“I don't intend to delay." Adora laughed, for now she was free to move between worlds.

“Give our regards to Queen Angela." said King Randor. "She has been a great help to us."

“She'll be happy to hear that all went well."

Teela offered her a handshake, but the blonde pulled her into a hug:

“I'm grateful to fight by your side. Take care of my brother."

The redhead laughed, returning the hug:

“I'll always take care of it, even though I know he's He-man."

It was Adam's turn, his words barely came out, he hugged his sister:

“Take care, Adora." He looked at Catra "I know that with you will be in good hands."

The cat smiled, she could guarantee that she would be by Adora's side.

They said goodbye and entered the portal hand in hand. Sorceress promised them that the portal would always be open, just wish it would appear, it was her gift of thanks for everything He-man and She-ra did for the universe.

****

On the other side, they could see Bright Moon. The walk was not long, but as soon as they had to walk, Swift Wind appeared flying at high speed:

"They Came back! They Came back! Adora is back!"

He knocked her to the ground, neighing with glee, which got a few laughs, even from Catra.

“I'm glad to see you too."

"Everyone is in Bright Moon in the meeting room, I can take you quickly!"

"So let's go! Adora mounted and held out her hand to Catra, who took it. It was a quick walk, they arrived at the palace where they

were welcomed by the other princesses."

"Catra!" Scorpia hugged her, lifting her off the ground "I thought I wouldn't see you anymore!"

"Long story." She laughed "But don't worry."

"So Adora's staying here?" asked Glimmer

"That's the best part!" replied the blonde "I don't have to choose! I can come back whenever I want!"

Glimmer hugged her, followed by Bow:

"Best Friends Forever reunited!"

They laughed together, celebrated a peace they hadn't had for a long time.

Only Entrapta was secluded in her corner, some kind of tablet in her hand. Adora saw her, not knowing what to say, as Hordak sacrificed himself to save everyone. She approached slowly:

"Entrapta, I... We... About what happened..."

The purple haired girl raised her face, sketching a smile:

"I'm fine, don't worry. I know he will make it back, my indicators show that."

She didn't say anything else, after all, there was no reason to doubt that. He wasn't dead, he was just in another dimension. If they found Queen Angela, then it wasn't impossible.

“It's never goodbye." Adora said to herself.

In Bright Moon's realm she was able to tell what happened after the portal was closed and how the two planets will always be connected. She wanted to help Catra with what happened in Salineas, and little by little the kingdom would rise again.

The realms thrived on the peace brought about by the help of the heroes of Grayskull, their names echoing in history for years to come.

Chapter End Notes

thanks to everyone who read.

I've had the idea for this story since Queen Angela sacrificed herself to take the sword and make reality return to normal. I have the theory that she didn't die, she was just trapped between dimensions and that would be a great reason to bring He-man and Adora's past into the narrative.

End Notes

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